USER MANUAL · VERSION 1.0 · OCTOBER 2026

SANE Studio user manual

This manual walks through SANE Studio from the first screen to the last download. Every button, setting, chart and message is covered, in the order you meet them. The screenshots come from the product itself, using the sample dataset that ships with it, so you can follow along on your own copy.

`.edf` `.bdf` `.vhdr · .vmrk · .eeg` `.set · .fdt` `.fif`

CONTENTS

1. About SANE Studio
2. Starting SANE Studio
3. Files you can upload
4. The four screens
5. The top bar
6. Screen 1: Upload
7. Screen 2: Review recordings
8. Neutralization settings
9. Screen 3: Processing
10. Screen 4: Results
11. The signal viewer
12. Analysis tabs
13. Your output files
14. Privacy and data handling
15. Messages and what to do
16. Troubleshooting
17. For administrators
18. Glossary

The web version of this manual is at `/manual` on any SANE Studio server, for example `http://localhost:8000/manual`.

1 About SANE Studio

SANE Studio takes EEG recordings and removes the subject-level biomarkers that can reveal a person's neurological condition, such as an elevated theta/beta ratio. You get the data back in the same file format you uploaded, so it can go into the same analysis pipeline as before.

SANE stands for **Spectral Attribute Neutralization for EEG**. For each person it measures two things that stay roughly constant across a recording: how much power each channel has in each frequency band (the spectral profile), and how the channels move together within each band (the spatial covariance). It then moves both onto a shared reference, so the profile that marks one person as different from the others is gone.

What changes and what stays

CHANGED	KEPT
Each subject's band-power profile per channel (delta, theta, alpha, beta, gamma), including the theta/beta ratio	Moment-to-moment brain activity: event-related responses, oscillation bursts, ERD/ERS
Each subject's spatial fingerprint: the channel-to-channel correlations within each band	Every event marker, with the same times and labels
Personal header fields such as name, birth date and recording date (optional, on by default)	EOG, ECG, EMG, trigger and other non-EEG channels, bit for bit
	File format, sampling rate, channel names, channel order and recording length

What SANE Studio is not

SANE Studio neutralizes subject-level spectral and spatial biomarkers. It is not a complete anonymization tool. Individual traits outside those statistics, such as the exact frequency of a person's alpha peak, can remain in the data. Treat processed files as de-identified research data, not as anonymous data.

2 Starting SANE Studio

If SANE Studio is hosted for you online, open its web address and skip to section 4. To run it on your own Windows computer, follow these steps.

What you need

- Python 3.10 or newer (from python.org).
- A modern browser: Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari.
- Free memory of about twice the size of the recording you process. A one-hour, 64-channel recording at 1000 Hz needs roughly 2 GB.
- Free disk space for working files. One session can use several GB while it is open.

Steps

1. **Open PowerShell.** Press the Windows key, type `PowerShell` and open it.
2. **Go to the project folder.**

   ```
   cd "E:\Brain signal work\sane-studio"
   ```

3. **Install the packages (first time only).**

   ```
   pip install -r requirements.txt
   ```

4. **Choose where working files go.** By default they go to the Windows temp folder on drive C:. If C: is small, point them at another drive:

   ```
   $env:SANE_DATA_DIR = "D:\sane_jobs"
   ```

5. **Start the server.**

   ```
   python -m uvicorn app.main:app --port 8000
   ```

   Wait for the line `Application startup complete`. Leave this window open: closing it stops SANE Studio.

6. **Open the app.** In your browser, go to `http://localhost:8000`. This manual is at `http://localhost:8000/manual`.
7. **Stop it when you are done.** Click the PowerShell window and press `Ctrl` + `C`.

Next time

You only need steps 1, 2, 4, 5 and 6. The packages stay installed.

3 Files you can upload

SANE Studio reads continuous EEG recordings in five formats. Some formats are split across several files, and you need to upload all of them together. Upload them in one go, or drop the whole folder.

FORMAT	UPLOAD THESE FILES	YOU GET BACK
EDF / EDF+	`recording.edf`	`recording_sane.edf`
BDF / BDF+ (Biosemi)	`recording.bdf`	`recording_sane.bdf`
BrainVision	`recording.vhdr` + `recording.vmrk` + `recording.eeg`	the same three files with `_sane` added, in a zip
EEGLAB	`recording.set`, plus `recording.fdt` if the recording has one	`recording_sane.set` (plus `recording_sane.fdt` if you uploaded a .fdt)
FIF (MNE / Neuromag)	`recording.fif` or `recording.fif.gz`; for a split recording, every part	`recording_sane_raw.fif`

Things to know before you upload

- **Companion files are matched for you.** A BrainVision header is paired with its marker and data files even if the files were renamed after recording. An EEGLAB .set is paired with the .fdt of the same name.
- **Different formats can share one session.** You can upload EDF and BrainVision files together; each one comes back in its own format.
- **Recordings must be continuous.** Files already cut into trials (epoched files) are refused. Upload the continuous recording.
- **Each recording needs at least two scalp EEG channels and at least 10 seconds of data.**
- **The default upload limit is 1024 MB per session.** An administrator can change it (section 17).

Files that look right but cannot be processed

Some files share an EEG extension but hold no EEG. SANE Studio recognizes them and tells you why it skipped them (section 15):

- EyeLink eye-tracker files, which also end in `.edf`.
- MEG-only `.fif` files, including "empty room" noise recordings with no person in the scanner.

- Part 2 or later of a split `.fif` recording uploaded without part 1.
- DataLad, git-annex or Git LFS placeholders: small text files that stand in for a recording that was never downloaded.
- Damaged files, such as a BrainVision data file cut off during copying, or a file whose values are physically impossible for EEG.
- Recordings whose scalp EEG channels contain no signal at all.

4 The four screens

Working with SANE Studio always follows the same path. You can go back from the results to the settings as often as you like.

1 · Upload → **2 · Review recordings** → **3 · Processing** → **4 · Results**

1. **Upload**: add your files, or try a sample dataset (section 6).
2. **Review recordings**: check what SANE Studio found in each file, set subject IDs and choose settings (sections 7 and 8).
3. **Processing**: a progress screen while SANE Studio works (section 9).
4. **Results**: compare input and output, read the privacy report and download your files (sections 10 to 12).

The address bar shows a session code after the `#` sign, for example `localhost:8000/#8f8a1406d407`. Reloading the page, or opening that address again while the session is alive, brings you back to the same place.

5 The top bar

The bar at the top of every screen holds these controls.



Figure 1. The top bar before you upload anything: the logo, Manual and the theme button.



Figure 2. The top bar once a session exists: session indicator, New session, Manual and the theme button.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
SANE Studio logo	Returns to the Upload screen. Your session stays alive; reopen it from its address while it lasts.
Session · data deleted in N min	Shows how long your files stay on the server. The countdown restarts whenever you use the session and updates every 30 seconds. When it reaches zero, everything in the session is deleted.
New session	Deletes the current session and all its files right away, then returns to the Upload screen. Use it when you are finished, or to start over.
Manual	Opens this manual in a new browser tab, so your session stays open in the first one.
Moon icon	Switches between the light and dark colour theme. Your choice is remembered in this browser. Charts redraw in the new colours.

6 Screen 1: Upload

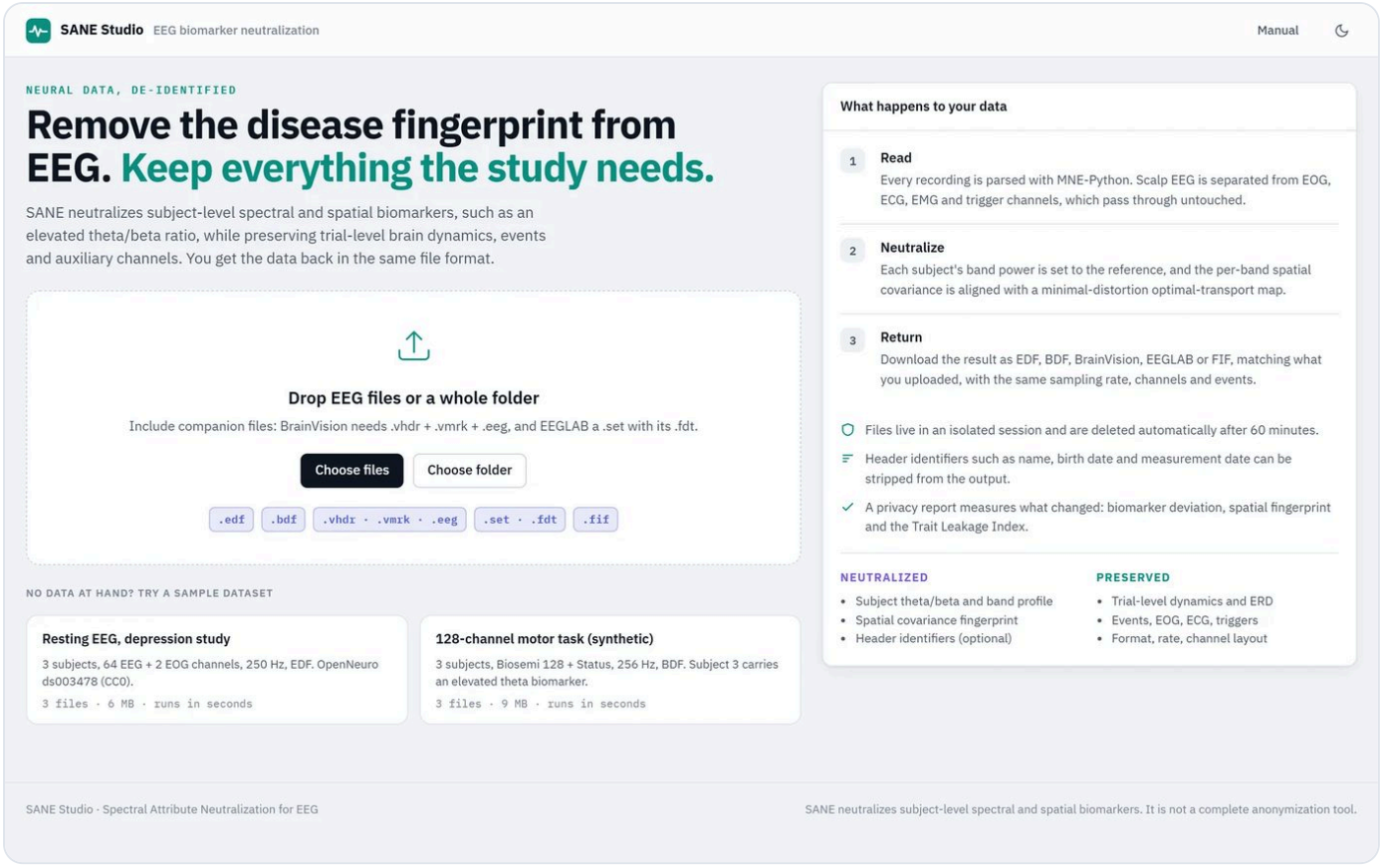


Figure 3. The Upload screen: the drop zone on the left, sample datasets below it, and a summary of what happens to your data on the right.

The drop zone

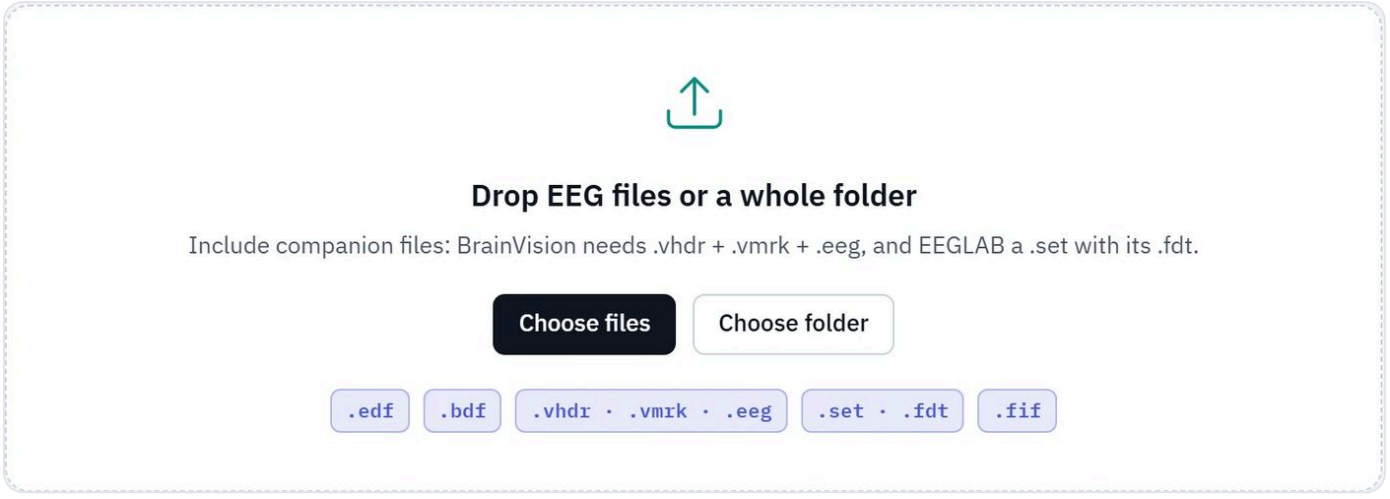


Figure 4. The drop zone.

There are three ways to add files:

- **Drag and drop.** Drag files, or a whole folder, from File Explorer onto the dashed box. The box turns teal while you hold files over it. Folders are searched, including their subfolders.

- **Choose files** opens a file picker. Hold `Ctrl` to select several files, for example a .vhdr, .vmrk and .eeg together.
- **Choose folder** uploads every supported file in a folder you pick, including subfolders.

The chips under the buttons list the accepted extensions. SANE Studio ignores files with other extensions, so dropping a folder that also holds spreadsheets or documents is fine.

While files upload, the title of the drop zone shows progress, for example `Uploading 3 files · 45% of 167.3 MB`. When the upload finishes, the Review screen opens.

Sample datasets



Figure 5. The two built-in sample datasets.

Click a card to start a session with that data, exactly as if you had uploaded it. Both run in a few seconds.

- **Resting EEG, depression study**: three subjects, 64 EEG and 2 EOG channels, 250 Hz, EDF. Real recordings from OpenNeuro dataset ds003478 (public domain, CC0).
- **128-channel motor task (synthetic)**: three subjects, Biosemi 128 channels plus Status, 256 Hz, BDF. Subject 3 carries an elevated theta biomarker, so you can watch SANE remove it.

What happens to your data

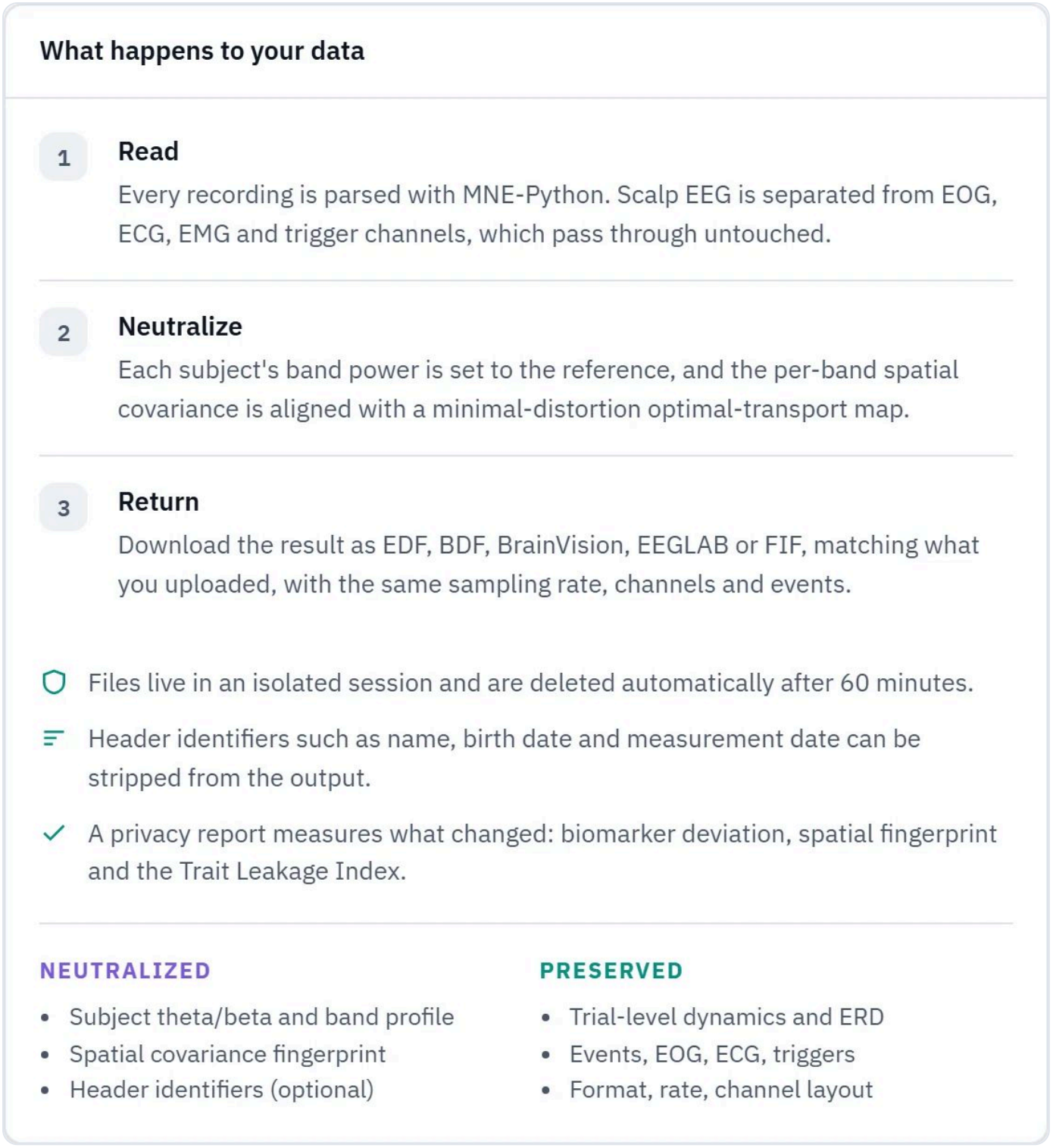


Figure 6. The summary panel.

The panel on the right of the Upload screen is information only; it has no controls. It summarizes the process:

1. **Read**: each recording is parsed with MNE-Python, and scalp EEG is separated from EOG, ECG, EMG and trigger channels.
2. **Neutralize**: each subject's band power and channel relationships are moved to the reference.

3. **Return**: you download the result in the format you uploaded.

Below the steps it lists the privacy promises (session deletion after 60 minutes, optional header stripping, the privacy report) and what is neutralized versus preserved.

The footer

Figure 7. The footer repeats the product's scope: it neutralizes subject-level biomarkers and is not a complete anonymization tool.

7 Screen 2: Review recordings

After an upload, SANE Studio opens every file, works out what it contains, and shows the result here before anything is changed. Check this screen carefully: it is where you set subject IDs and choose how strongly to neutralize.

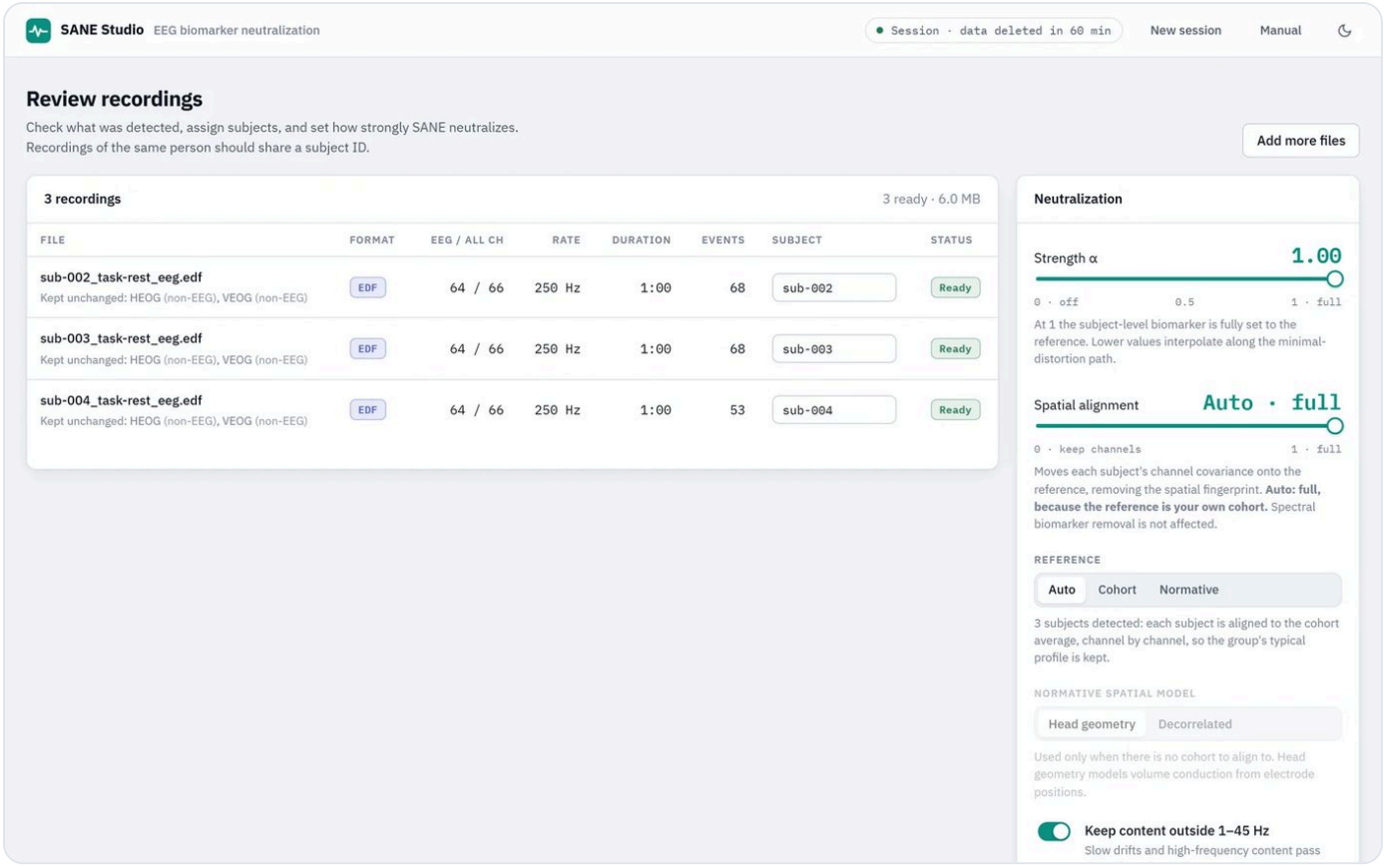


Figure 8. The Review screen with the depression sample loaded: the recordings table on the left, the Neutralization settings on the right.

Add more files

The **Add more files** button at the top right adds files to the same session, for example a subject you forgot. The table updates when the upload finishes. You cannot add files while a session is processing.

The recordings table

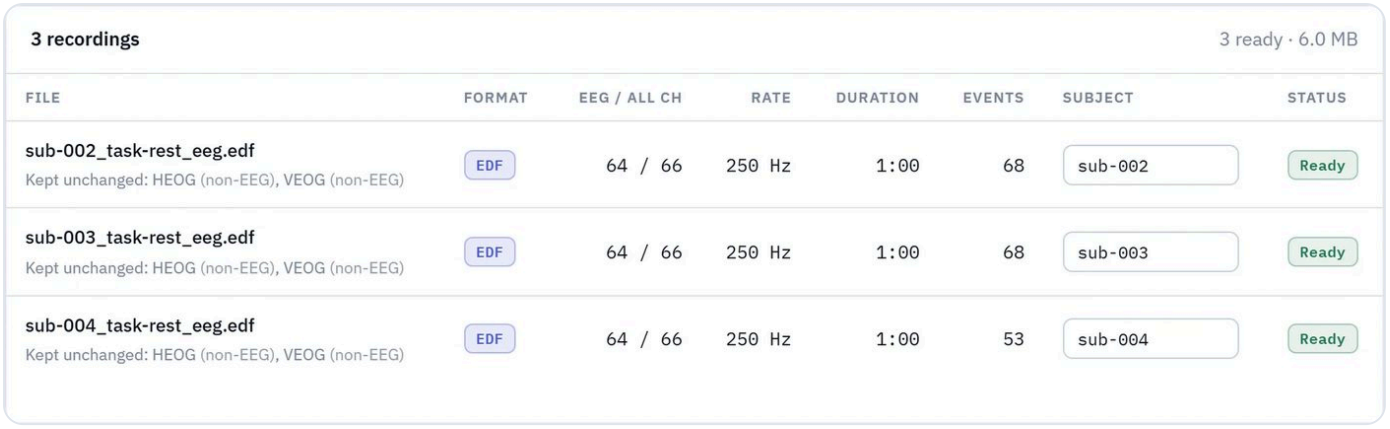


Figure 9. One row per recording. The header shows the count, how many are ready, and the total size.

COLUMN	MEANING
File	The header file of the recording. Lines underneath give more detail (see below).
Format	EDF, BDF, BrainVision, EEGLAB or FIF.
EEG / all ch	How many channels SANE Studio will process as scalp EEG, out of all channels in the file. The rest pass through unchanged.
Rate	Sampling rate in Hz.
Duration	Recording length (minutes:seconds, or seconds for short recordings).
Events	Number of event markers or annotations in the file. They are all kept.
Subject	The subject ID used to group recordings. You can edit it (see Subject IDs).
Status	`Ready` means the recording will be processed. `Skipped` means it cannot be, and the reason is shown under the file name.

Lines under the file name

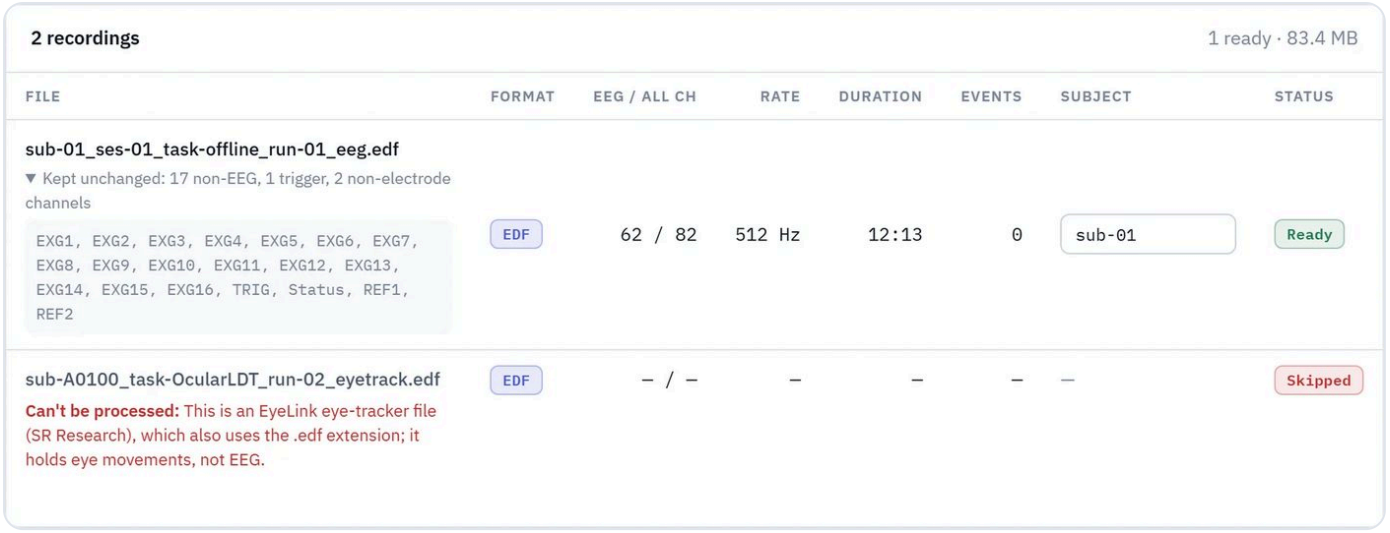


Figure 10. A real upload with two files. The first is ready, and its list of untouched channels is opened. The second is an eye-tracker file and is skipped, with the reason in red.

- **+ companion files** (grey): the other files that belong to this recording, such as `+ recording.fdt`.
- **Kept unchanged** (grey): channels that will pass through untouched, with the reason for each. With six or fewer, they are listed by name. With more, you see a count by type, for example "17 non-EEG, 1 trigger, 2 non-electrode channels"; click the line to show every name.
- **Amber text**: a warning that does not stop processing, for example a missing companion file.
- **Can't be processed** (red): the reason a recording is skipped. Section 15 lists every reason and what to do about it.

The reasons a channel is kept unchanged are:

SHOWN AS	MEANING
EOG, ECG, EMG, trigger, misc, MEG	The file itself marks the channel as that type.
non-EEG	The file calls it EEG, but the name shows otherwise (EOG, ECG, EKG, EMG, Status, Trigger, GSR, respiration, temperature, accelerometer and similar).
sensor	The channel is stored in a unit that is not a voltage, such as nS, nA or degrees.
non-electrode	The other EEG channels use standard 10-20/10-05 names, but this one is not an electrode name. Typical examples are reference electrodes, mastoids, audio recorded alongside the EEG, or driving-simulator signals.
flat	The channel carries no signal anywhere in the recording.
marked bad	The file lists the channel as bad.

Notes under the table tell you about files that were ignored, for example a `.fdt` without its `.set`, or a file that is not EEG at all.

Subject IDs

SANE Studio builds one correction per subject. Recordings with the same subject ID are treated as the same person: their statistics are combined, and in a group they count once toward the reference.

- SANE Studio fills the ID in from the file name when it follows the BIDS style (`sub-001_task-rest_eeg.edf` gives `sub-001`). Otherwise it uses the file name.
- **Give recordings of the same person the same ID**, for example two sessions of one patient.
- **Give different people different IDs.** This matters when you mix files from different studies, which often reuse labels such as `sub-01`.
- The number of different IDs decides whether a group (cohort) reference can be used. The Reference hint in the settings panel updates as you type.

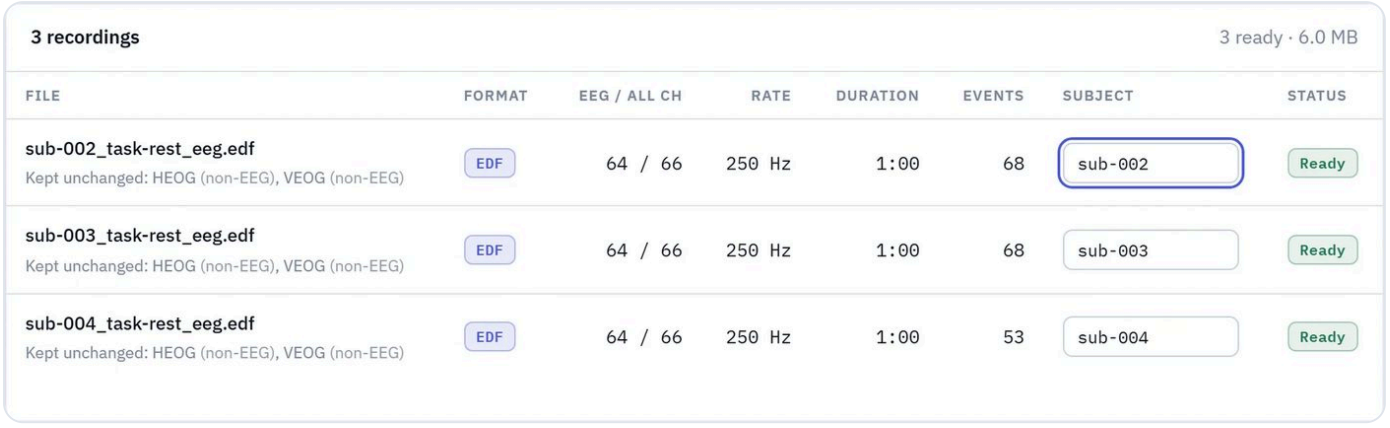


Figure 11. Subject IDs are edited directly in the table. A box left empty gives that recording an ID of its own, so it counts as a separate subject.

8 Neutralization settings

The panel on the right of the Review screen controls how SANE Studio processes the recordings. The defaults suit most uses: full strength, automatic spatial alignment, automatic reference, both switches on.

Neutralization

Strength α **1.00**

0 · off 0.5 1 · full

At 1 the subject-level biomarker is fully set to the reference. Lower values interpolate along the minimal-distortion path.

Spatial alignment **Auto · full**

0 · keep channels 1 · full

Moves each subject's channel covariance onto the reference, removing the spatial fingerprint. **Auto: full, because the reference is your own cohort.** Spectral biomarker removal is not affected.

REFERENCE

Auto | Cohort | Normative

3 subjects detected: each subject is aligned to the cohort average, channel by channel, so the group's typical profile is kept.

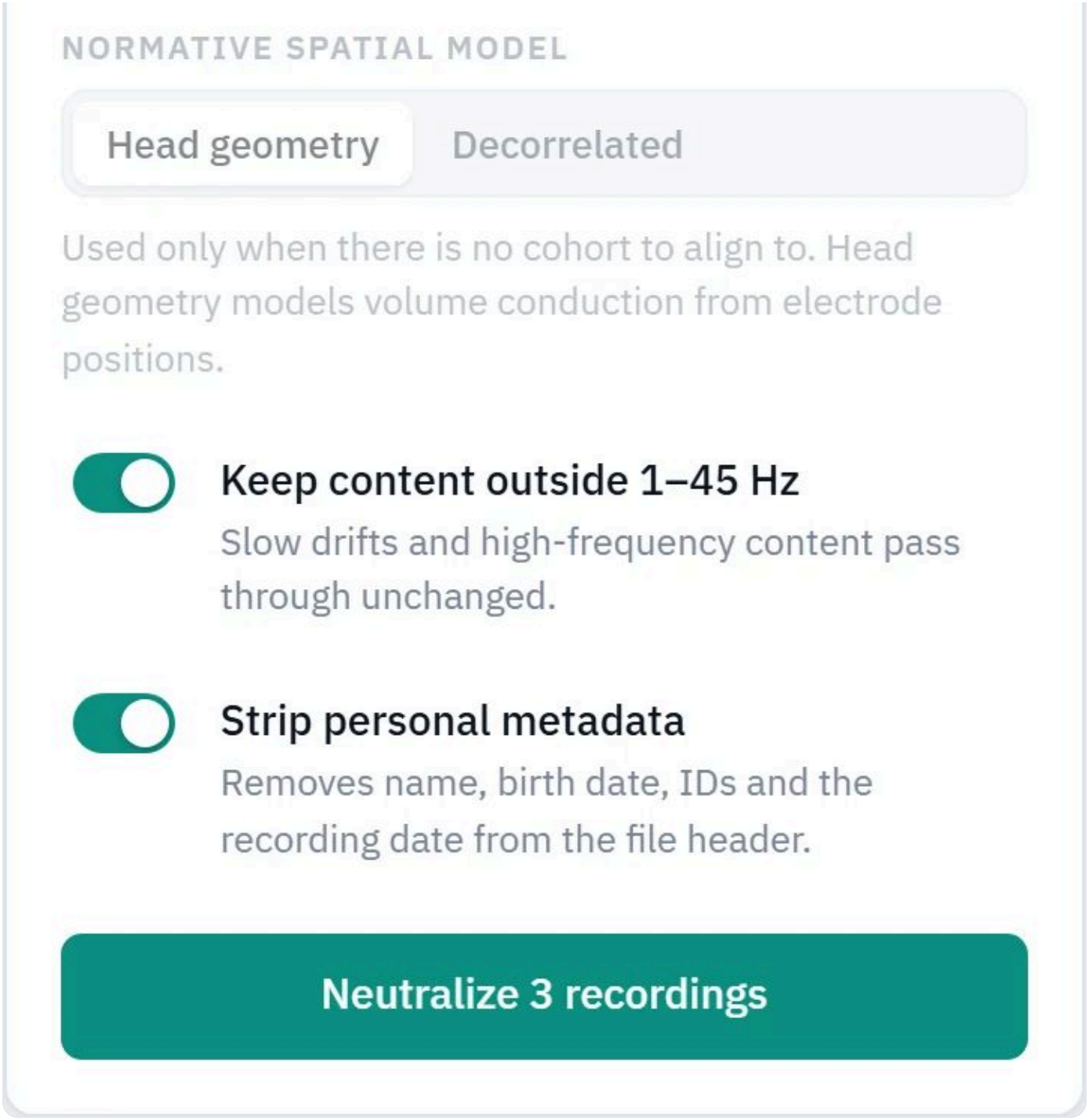


Figure 12. Default settings with three subjects uploaded.

Strength α

A slider from **0 (off)** to **1 (full)** in steps of 0.05. Default: 1.00.

At 1, each subject's band power per channel is set exactly to the reference. At 0, with Spatial alignment on Auto, the output is identical to the input. Values in between move part of the way: at 0.5, a channel's power ends up halfway between its own value and the reference on a logarithmic scale.

Lower the strength only if you need to keep part of each subject's individual profile and accept that some of the biomarker remains. For privacy, use 1.

Spatial alignment

A second slider from **0 (keep channels)** to **1 (full)**. It controls how far each subject's channel-to-channel correlations move onto the reference, which removes the spatial fingerprint. It does not affect removal of the spectral biomarker.

By default it is set to **Auto**, shown as `Auto · full` or `Auto · off`:

- **Auto · full** when recordings are aligned to your own cohort. The cohort is a measured reference, and in our tests the output kept a brain-dynamics score of 0.92 to 0.99. In this mode spatial alignment follows the strength: at strength 0.5 it is also 0.5.
- **Auto · off** when recordings are aligned to the built-in normative profile. The only spatial target there is a generic head model, and aligning to it rebuilds each channel largely from its neighbours, which costs much more of the signal.

Move the slider to choose a value yourself. The value then applies to every recording, and a **Back to auto** link appears under the slider to restore the automatic choice.

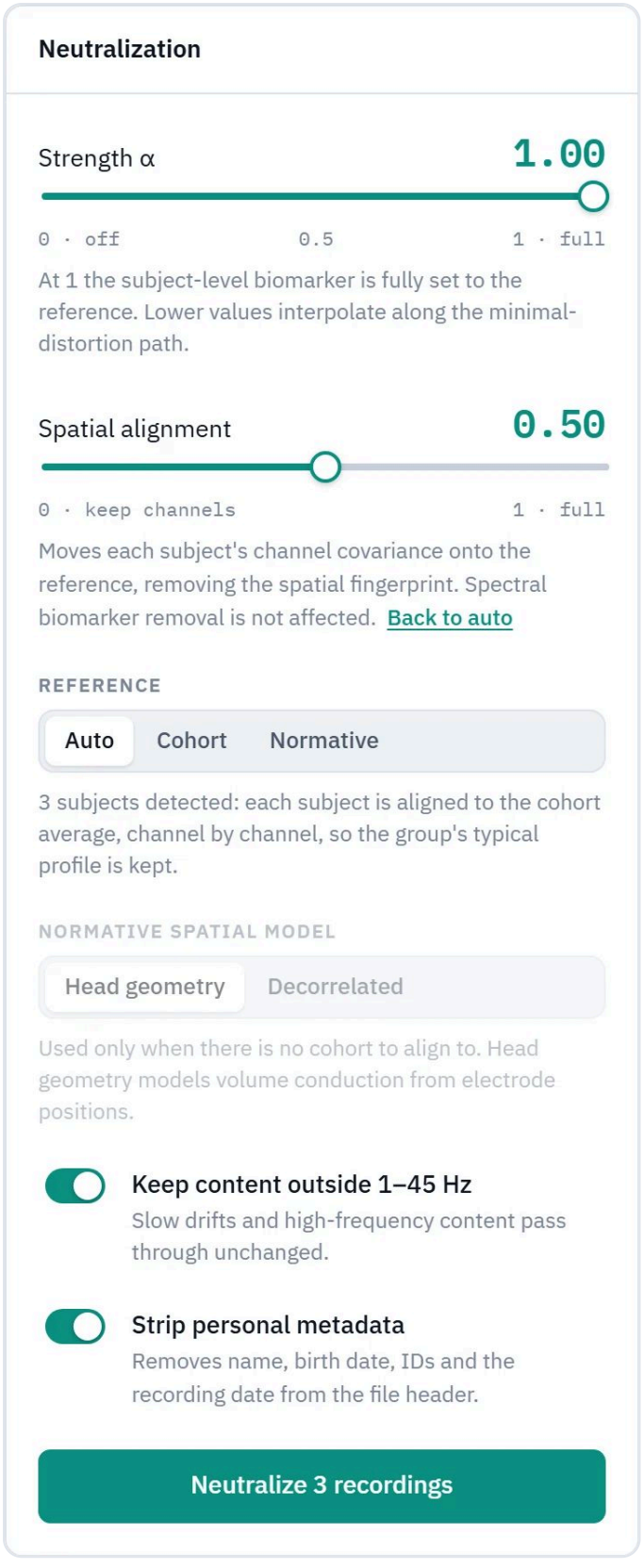


Figure 13. Spatial alignment set by hand to 0.50, with the Back to auto link.

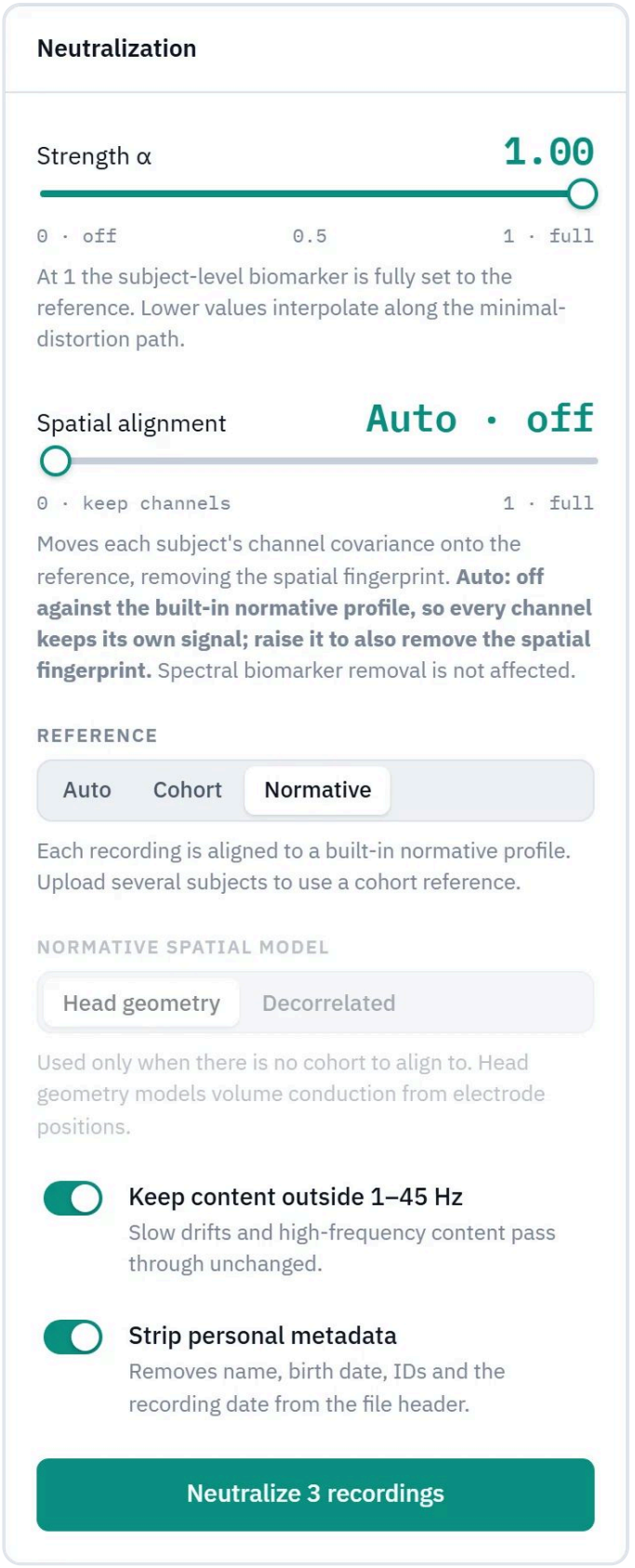


Figure 14. Reference set to Normative: spatial alignment switches to Auto · off and the hint explains why.

When to change spatial alignment

Lower it toward 0 if your analysis reads individual channels, such as ERP amplitude at Pz, and you want every channel to keep its own signal. Raise it toward 1 for a single subject if removing the spatial fingerprint matters more than keeping each channel exactly as recorded.

Reference

The reference is the profile every subject is moved toward. Three buttons choose it:

CHOICE	WHAT IT DOES
Auto (default)	Uses your cohort when there are at least two different subject IDs among the ready recordings. Otherwise uses the normative profile.
Cohort	Always uses the cohort average. With fewer than two subjects this is impossible, so the hint says the normative profile will be used instead.
Normative	Always uses the built-in normative profile, even when several subjects are uploaded.

The cohort reference is the average of your subjects, built channel by channel. Each subject counts once, however many recordings they have. Channels are matched by name, ignoring upper and lower case and spaces, so slightly different montages still line up. This keeps the group's typical profile, so group-level analyses of the processed data stay meaningful.

The normative profile is a built-in typical spectral shape. Each channel keeps its own overall power and takes on the normative balance between bands.

The hint under the buttons tells you which reference will be used. Two cases are handled automatically during processing and reported in the results:

- In a cohort, a recording whose channel names barely overlap with any other subject's (less than half of its channels) is matched to the normative profile instead. Without that, it would be compared only with itself and come back unchanged.
- Within a cohort, a channel that only one subject has gets the cohort's average spectral shape at its own power level.

Normative spatial model

Two buttons decide what the spatial target looks like when a recording uses the normative profile *and* spatial alignment is above 0. Otherwise this setting has no effect, and it is shown dimmed.

CHOICE	WHAT IT DOES
Head geometry (default)	Models how signals spread across the scalp from the distance between electrodes. Positions come from the file, or are matched by channel name to the standard 10-05, Biosemi or EGI layouts. Channels without a known position keep their own relationships.
Decorrelated	Treats every channel as independent of the others. This removes the most spatial information and changes the signal the most.

Keep content outside 1–45 Hz

A switch, on by default. SANE Studio works on five bands: delta 1–4 Hz, theta 4–8 Hz, alpha 8–13 Hz, beta 13–30 Hz and gamma 30–45 Hz. With the switch on, slow drifts below 1 Hz and content above 45 Hz pass through the EEG channels unchanged. With it off, that content is removed from the processed EEG channels. Non-EEG channels are never touched either way.

At low sampling rates, bands above the recording's frequency limit are left out. Below about 100 Hz sampling there is no gamma band, and below about 70 Hz no beta band either.

Strip personal metadata

A switch, on by default. It removes identifying fields from the header of each output file:

FORMAT	WHAT IS REMOVED
EDF, BDF	Patient identification becomes `X X X X`, recording identification becomes `Startdate X X X X`, and the start date and time become 01.01.85 00.00.00.
BrainVision	The recording date and time stored in the marker file is removed.
EEGLAB, FIF	Subject name, ID and sex are replaced, the experimenter field is replaced, and the measurement date becomes 1 January 2000. A birth date, if present, moves by the same amount, so age is kept.

Event times are stored relative to the start of the recording, so they stay correct. Turn the switch off only if you need the original dates in the output.

The Neutralize button

The button at the bottom of the panel starts processing. It names how many recordings will be processed, for example **Neutralize 3 recordings**. If no recording is ready, it reads **No recordings can be processed** and cannot be clicked.

Recommended settings

YOUR GOAL	SETTINGS
Share a group study with the disease markers removed	Upload all subjects together, give each person a unique ID, keep every default.
Process one person's recording	Keep the defaults. SANE Studio uses the normative profile and leaves spatial alignment off.
Remove a single subject's spatial fingerprint too	Defaults, then move Spatial alignment up, for example to 0.5 or 1.
Channel-level ERP analysis afterwards	Spatial alignment at 0, everything else default.
Check what SANE does without changing data	Strength 0 with Spatial alignment on Auto. The output is identical to the input, and the report shows the baseline numbers.

9 Screen 3: Processing

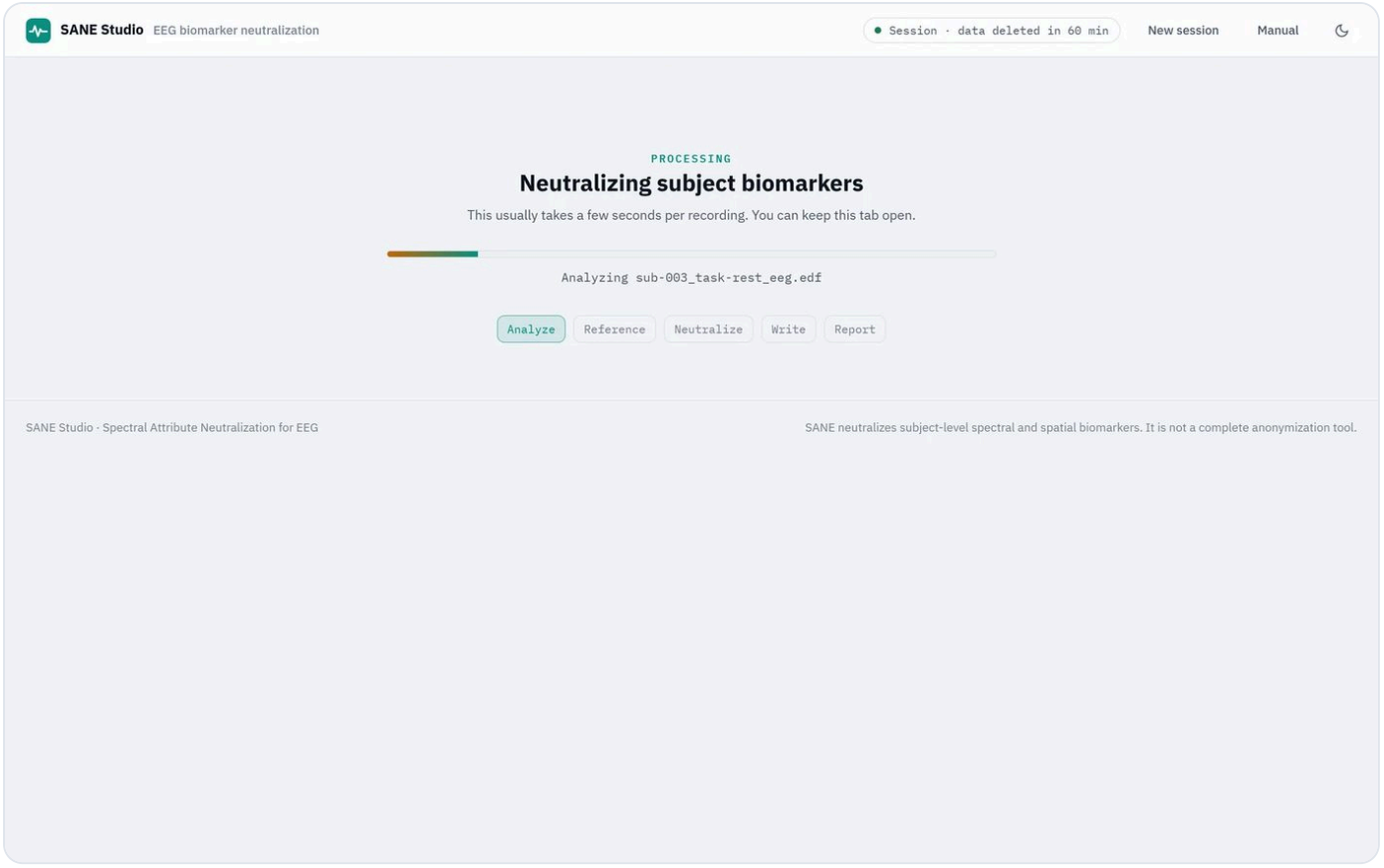


Figure 15. The Processing screen. The line under the bar names the step and the file in progress.

This screen has no controls. The bar fills as work progresses, the line under it says what is happening, and the five step labels light up in turn:

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
Analyze	Each recording is read and its channels are sorted. Windows with amplifier saturation, spikes, flat signal, missing samples or `BAD_` annotations are set aside. Band power and channel relationships are measured on the rest.
Reference	The cohort or normative reference is built, and one correction is computed per subject.
Neutralize	The correction is applied to the whole continuous recording.
Write	The output is written in the original format.
Report	The before/after measurements are calculated and the downloads are packaged.

Most recordings take a few seconds to a minute. A 30-minute, 64-channel recording takes about half a minute on a typical laptop. You can leave the tab open and wait; the results open by

themselves.

If one recording fails, the others are still processed, and the failed one is listed as skipped with its reason when you click **Change settings**. If every recording fails, you return to the Review screen with a message that names each file and its problem.

10 Screen 4: Results

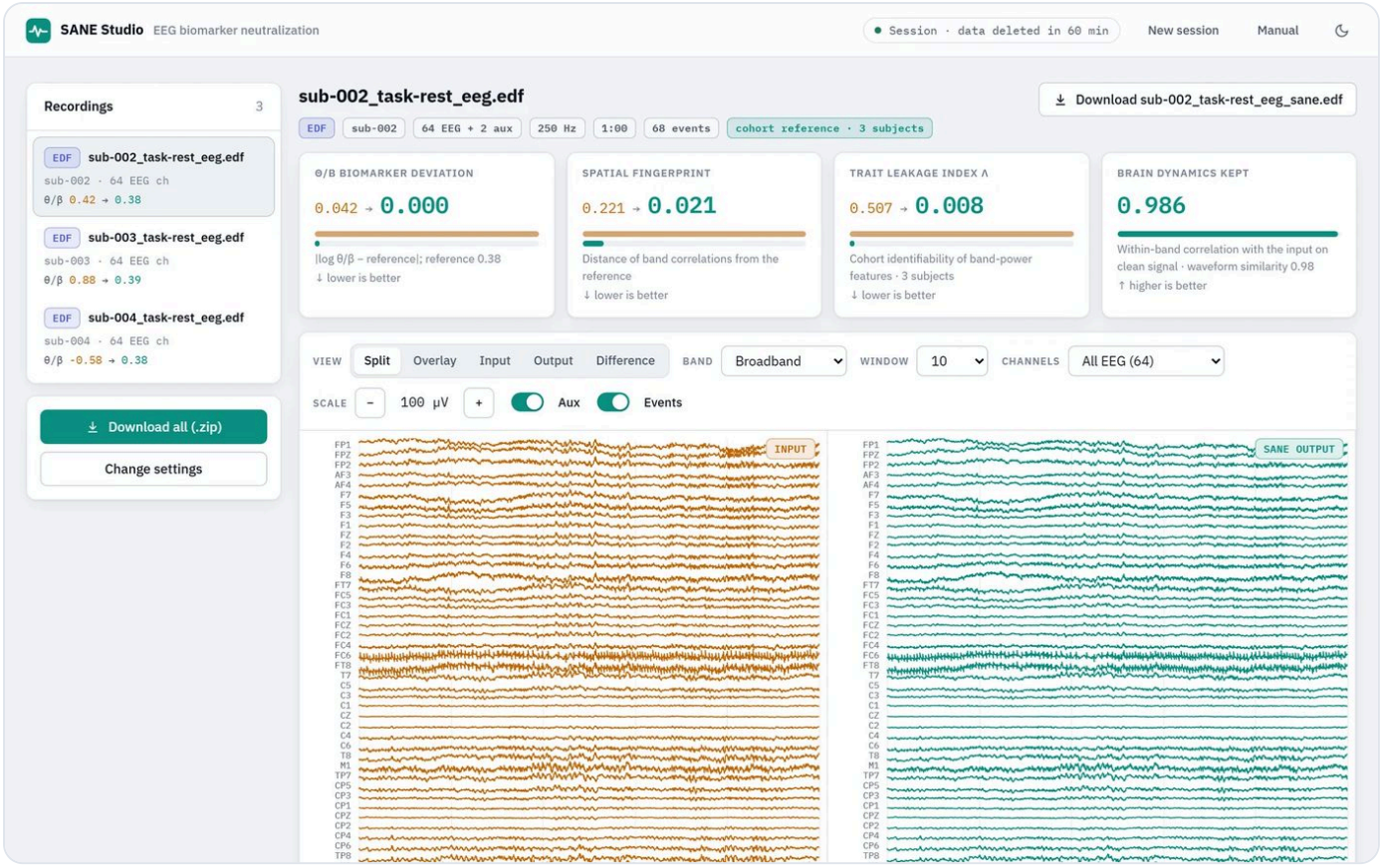


Figure 16. The Results screen: the recordings list on the left; the selected recording's details, summary cards and signal viewer on the right. The analysis tabs are further down.

The recordings list


Recordings
3
EDF
sub-002_task-rest_eeg.edf
sub-002 · 64 EEG ch
θ/β 0.42 → 0.38
EDF
sub-003_task-rest_eeg.edf
sub-003 · 64 EEG ch
θ/β 0.88 → 0.39
EDF
sub-004_task-rest_eeg.edf
sub-004 · 64 EEG ch
θ/β -0.58 → 0.38
Download all (.zip)



Figure 17. The list on the left.

Each processed recording has one entry showing its format, file name, subject ID, number of EEG channels, and its theta/beta biomarker before and after (`θ/β 0.88 → 0.39`). The amber number is the input, the teal number the output. Click an entry to show that recording. The selected one is highlighted.

Download all (.zip) downloads one zip file (`sane_outputs.zip`) with every output file and the full report, `SANE_REPORT.json` .

Change settings returns to the Review screen with the same files. There you can change settings or subject IDs, add files, and run again. A new run replaces the previous outputs.

The recording header

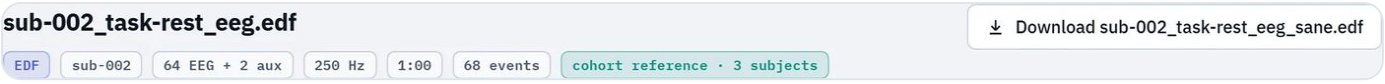


Figure 18. The header of the selected recording.

The title is the file name. The chips under it show format, subject ID, channel count (EEG plus auxiliary channels), sampling rate, duration, number of events, and the reference used:

- `cohort reference · 3 subjects` : aligned to the average of three subjects.
- `normative · kernel` : normative profile, spatial model from head geometry.
- `normative · own-spatial` : normative profile, and no electrode positions were found, so channel relationships stay as recorded.
- `normative · identity` : normative profile with the Decorrelated spatial model.

An amber note under the chips appears when something about this recording is worth knowing. For example, it was matched to the normative profile because its channel names did not overlap with the cohort, it contained missing samples, or it was written as .set + .fdt because of its size. Section 15 lists these notes.

The button on the right downloads this recording's output: a single file (**Download recording_sane.edf**), or a zip when the format has several files (**Download BrainVision bundle (.zip)**).

Summary cards

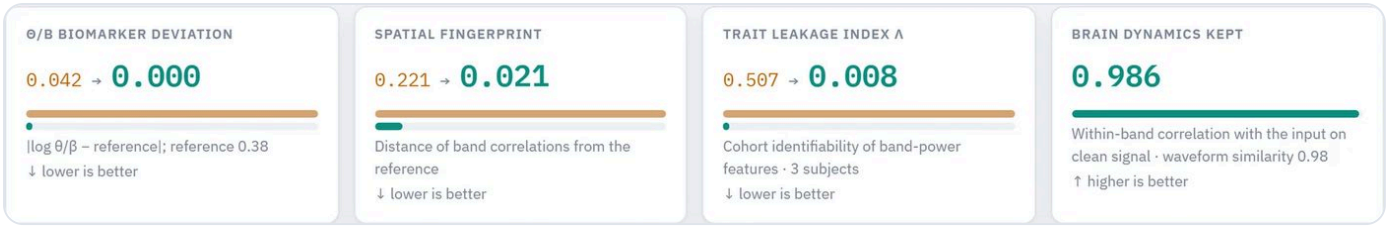


Figure 19. The four summary cards. Amber numbers describe the input, teal numbers the output.

CARD	HOW TO READ IT
θ/β biomarker deviation	How far this recording's theta/beta ratio (log scale, averaged over channels) is from the reference, before and after. Lower is better; 0 means the biomarker now equals the reference.
Spatial fingerprint	How far the channel-to-channel correlations are from the reference, averaged over bands. Lower is better. When spatial alignment was off, the card says so, and the two numbers stay close, as intended.
Trait Leakage Index Λ	How identifiable subjects are from their band-power features across the whole cohort, from 0 (cannot tell subjects apart) to 1 (fully identifiable). Lower is better. It needs at least two subjects who share channel names; otherwise the card explains why it is missing.
Brain dynamics kept	How closely the output follows the input within each band, measured on clean signal. 1 means the moment-to-moment activity is unchanged apart from the intended rescaling of each band. Higher is better. Waveform similarity, the plain correlation of the raw traces, is given underneath.

11 The signal viewer

The viewer shows the recording itself, input and output, with every channel. It is the place to check with your own eyes that the brain activity is still there.

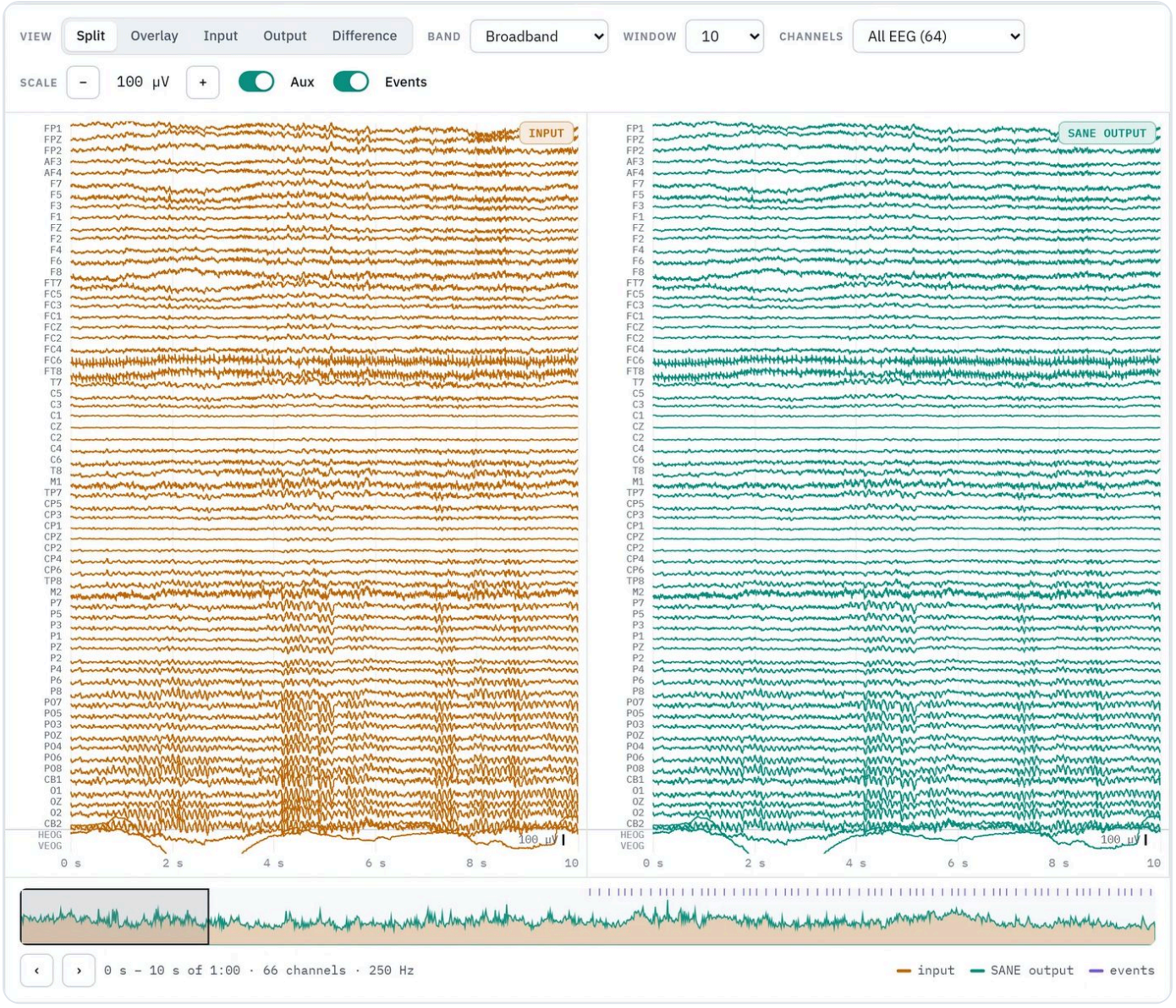


Figure 20. Split view: the input in amber on the left, the SANE output in teal on the right, with the same 10-second window and scale.

Toolbar

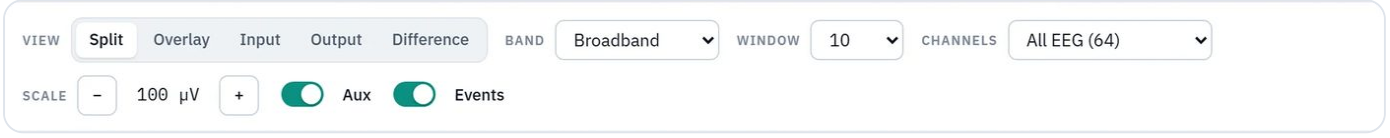


Figure 21. The viewer toolbar.

CONTROL	OPTIONS AND EFFECT
View	**Split**: input and output side by side (default). **Overlay**: both on one plot, input faint amber under output teal. **Input**: input only, full width. **Output**: output only, full width. **Difference**: output minus input, in violet, which shows exactly what SANE changed.
Band	Filters the display to one band: Broadband (default), δ 1–4 Hz, θ 4–8 Hz, α 8–13 Hz, β 13–30 Hz or γ 30–45 Hz. This only changes what you see; the files are not affected. Choosing a band resets the amplitude scale.
Window	How many seconds are shown at once: 2, 5, 10 (default), 20, 30 or 60.
Channels	Which channels are shown: **All EEG** (default), a brain region (Frontal, Central, Temporal, Parietal, Occipital, offered when channel names allow), blocks of 32 channels for montages with more than 40 (**Channels 1–32**, **33–64** and so on), or **Auxiliary only** for the pass-through channels.
Scale	`–` and `+` make the traces smaller or larger by a factor of 1.5. The value, in µV, is the vertical space given to each channel row. A scale bar with its size in µV sits at the bottom right of each plot. The scale is set automatically when a recording opens.
Aux	Shows or hides the auxiliary channels (EOG, ECG and other pass-through channels) below the EEG, under a separating line and with grey labels. Trigger channels are never drawn as traces.
Events	Shows or hides event markers: dashed violet lines with their labels at the top of the plot, and ticks on the timeline.

View modes

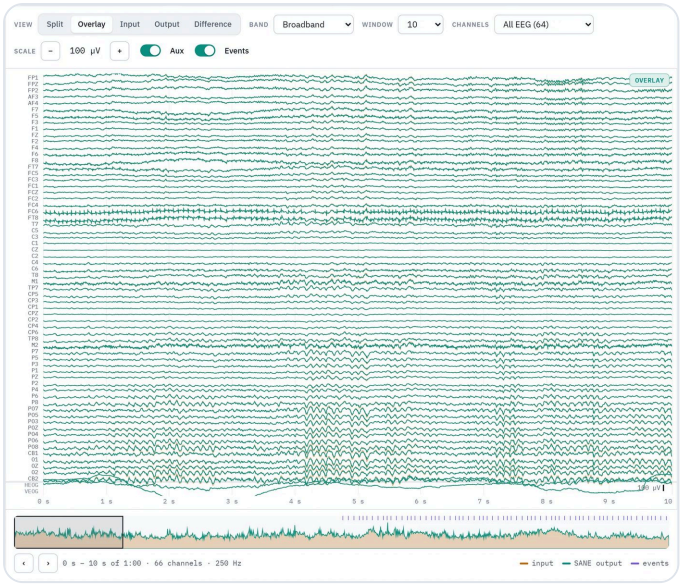


Figure 22. Overlay.

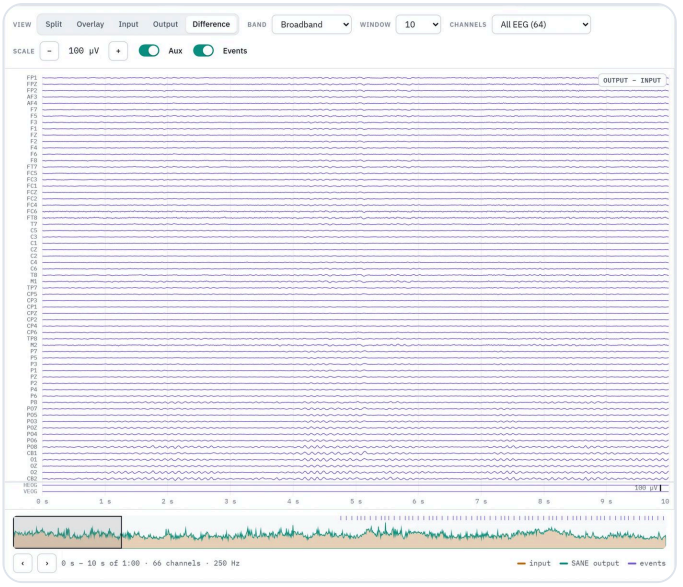


Figure 23. Difference: output minus input.

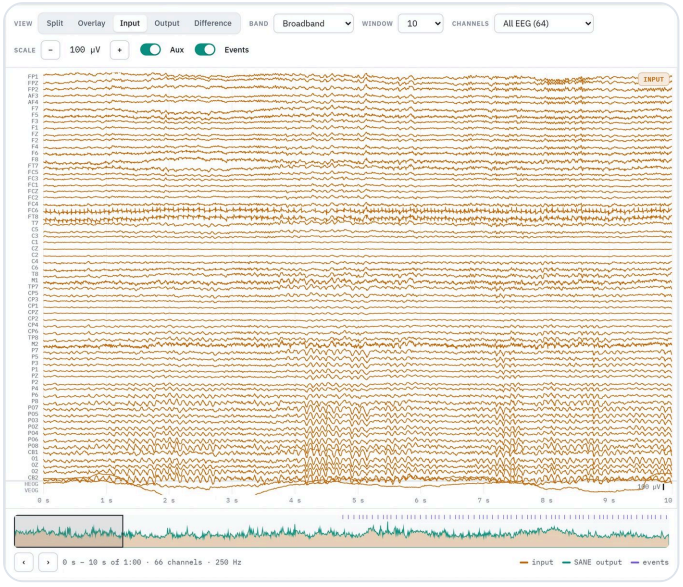


Figure 24. Input only.

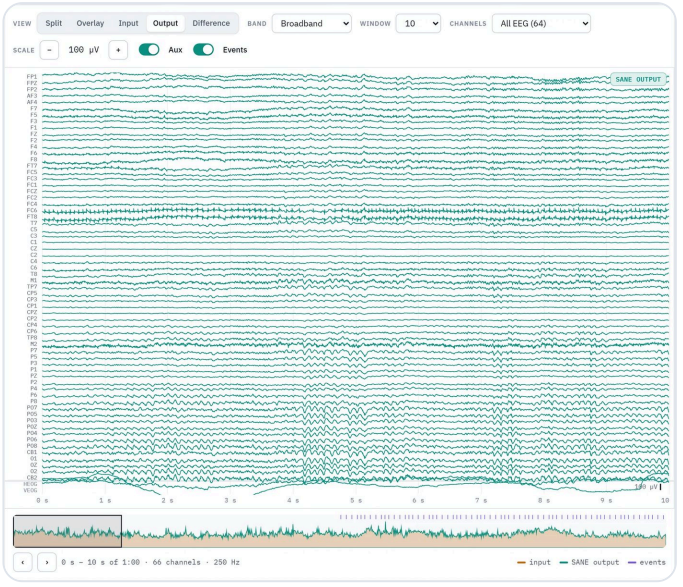


Figure 25. Output only.

Bands, channel groups and scale

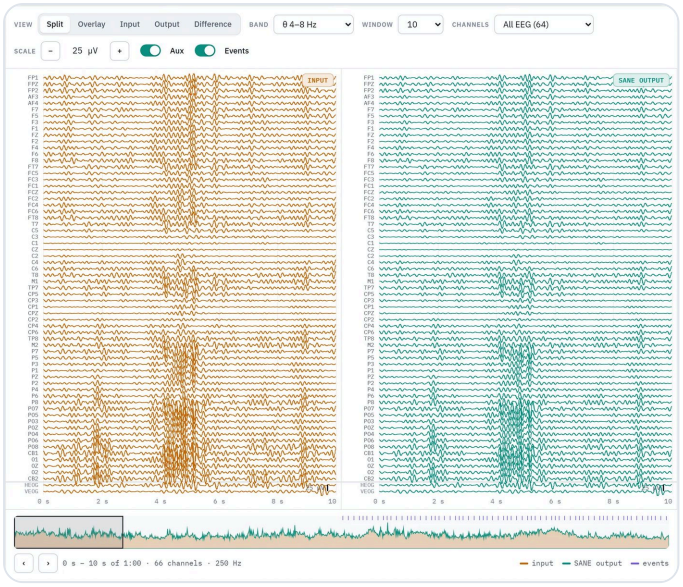


Figure 26. Band set to θ 4–8 Hz. Theta is where this subject's biomarker lived, so the output differs most here.

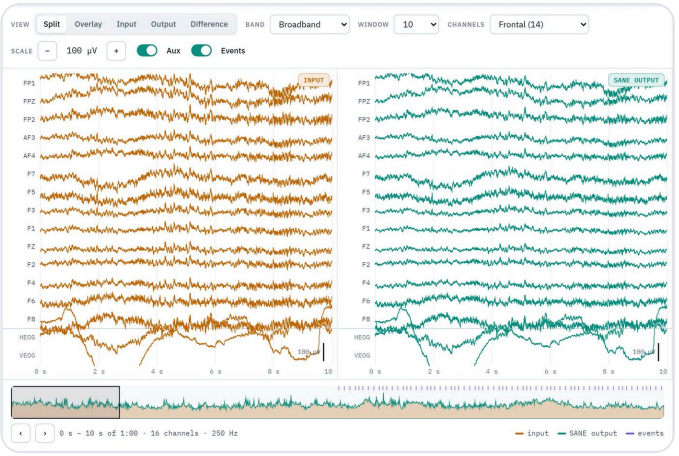


Figure 27. Channels set to a single region: fewer rows, more detail per channel.

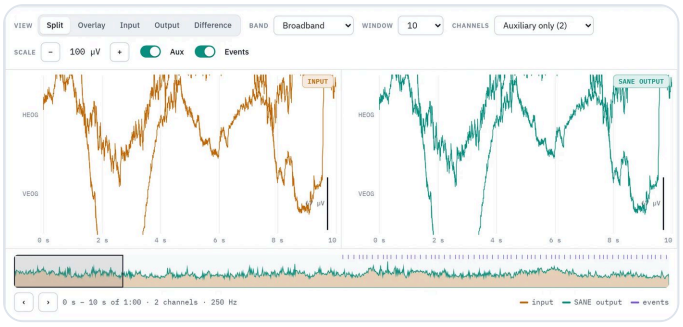


Figure 28. Auxiliary only: the two EOG channels are identical in input and output.

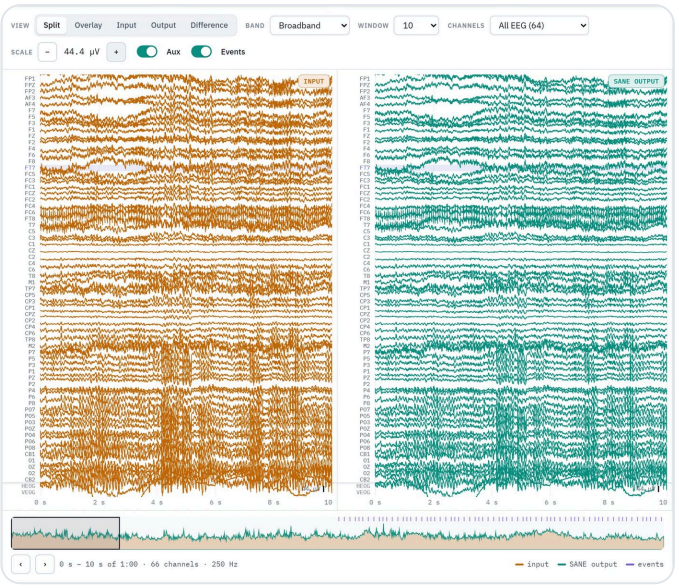


Figure 29. After pressing + twice: larger traces.

Reading values and selecting a channel

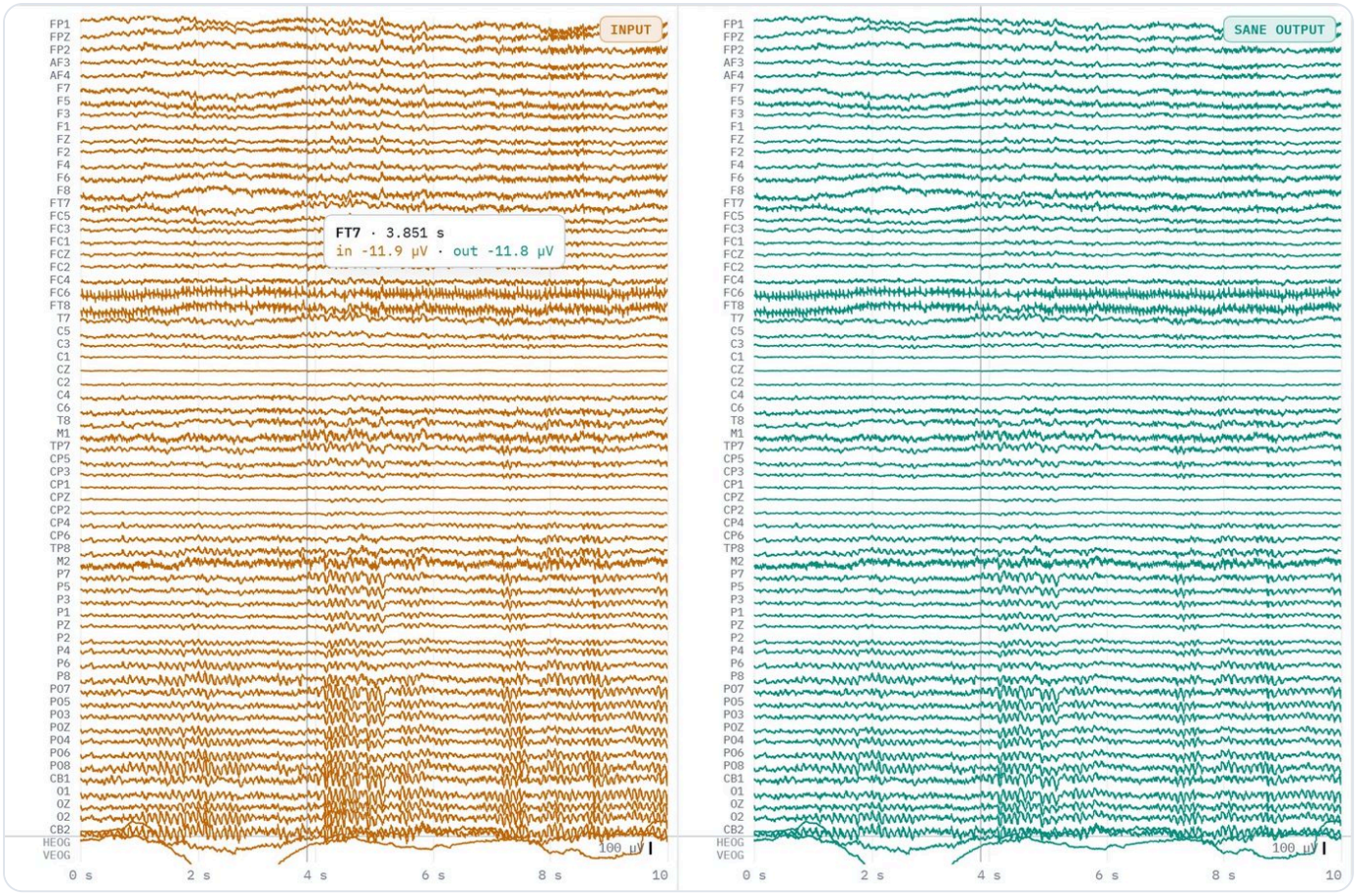


Figure 30. Hovering over a trace shows the channel, the time, and the input and output values in µV. A thin line marks the same moment in both plots.

Hover over any trace to read its values. **Click** a trace to select that channel: its row is highlighted, its label turns indigo, and the Spectrum tab switches to that channel. Click it again to clear the selection.

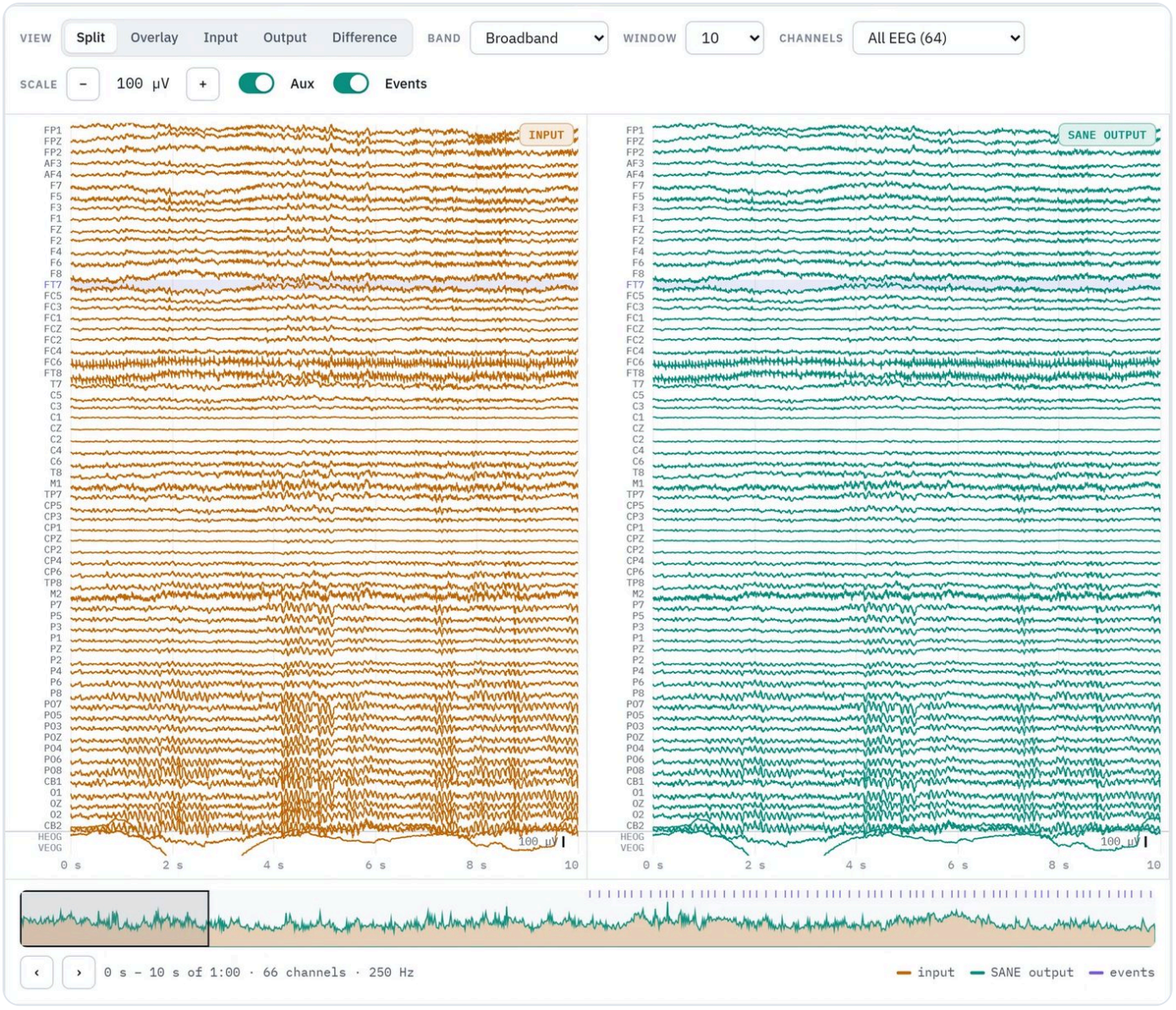


Figure 31. A selected channel, highlighted in both plots.

Timeline and moving through the recording



Figure 32. The timeline under the plots.

The strip under the plots shows the whole recording: the overall signal level of the input (amber) and output (teal), events as ticks, and the current window as a shaded box.

- **Click** anywhere on the timeline to jump there, or **drag** along it to scrub.
- The ‹ and › buttons move back or forward by one window.
- The ← and → arrow keys do the same, as long as the cursor is not in a text box or a menu.

- The line next to the buttons reads, for example, `0 s – 10 s of 1:00 · 66 channels · 250 Hz`.
- The legend on the right repeats the colours: input, SANE output, visible difference, events.

Difference strip and difference graph

When a channel is selected, a strip appears above the traces. It says for how long the input and the output can be told apart in this window, lists the longest time spans and gives the time of the largest gap. Two traces count as apart when they are at least 1.5 pixels from each other at the current amplitude scale, so the answer changes with `–` and `+`. A dense 64-channel view often shows no separation until you amplify it; that is correct, not a fault.

The panel **Difference timestamps by channel**, under the timeline, shows the same time spans for every channel in the window. Its first line says how many channels differ and which one differs most. It follows the window, band, channel group, scale and Events settings of the viewer. Two buttons next to the title choose how it is drawn.

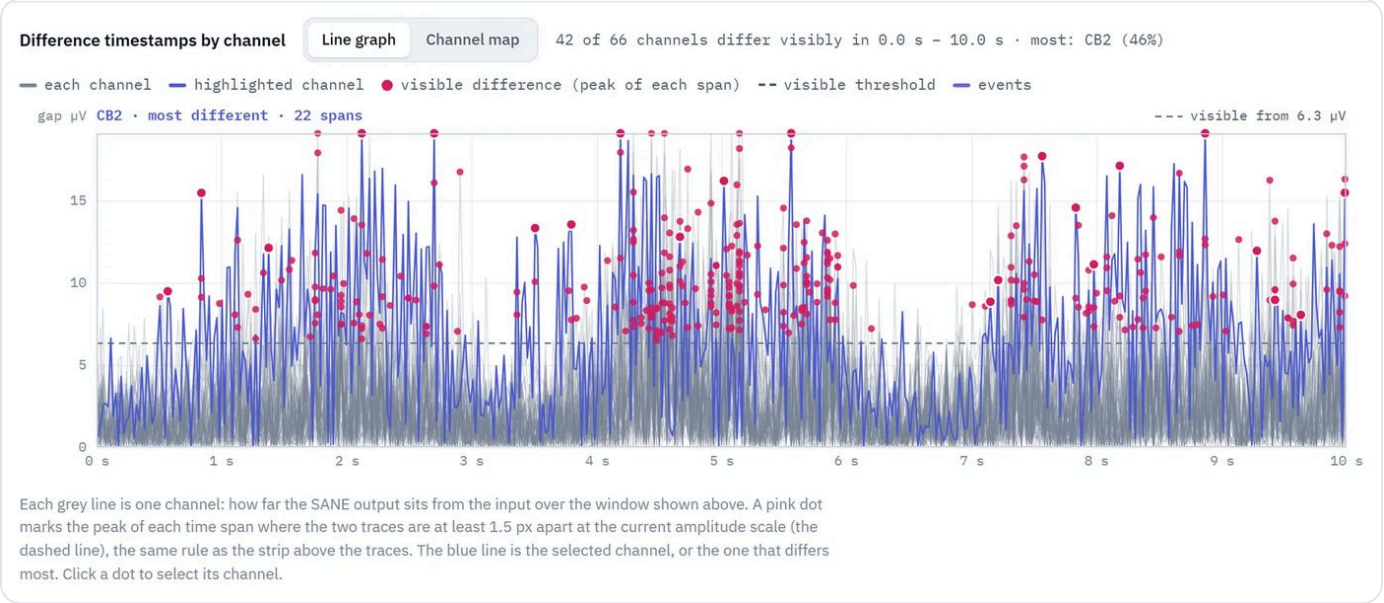


Figure 33. Line graph: how far the output sits from the input, in µV, for every channel over the window.



Figure 34. Channel map: the same time spans as blocks, one row per channel.

VIEW	HOW TO READ IT
Line graph	Each grey line is one channel. The blue line is the selected channel, or the channel that differs most if none is selected. A pink dot marks the largest gap of each time span, and the dashed line is the gap that becomes visible at the current scale. **Hover** over a dot to read its channel, time, gap and span. **Click** a dot to select its channel.
Channel map	Each row is one channel, and each pink block is one time span. The column on the right gives the share of the window with a visible difference. **Hover** to read the channel, the time and the span. **Click** a row to select that channel.

12 Analysis tabs

Below the viewer, five tabs measure what SANE changed in the selected recording. Click a tab name to switch.

Spectrum

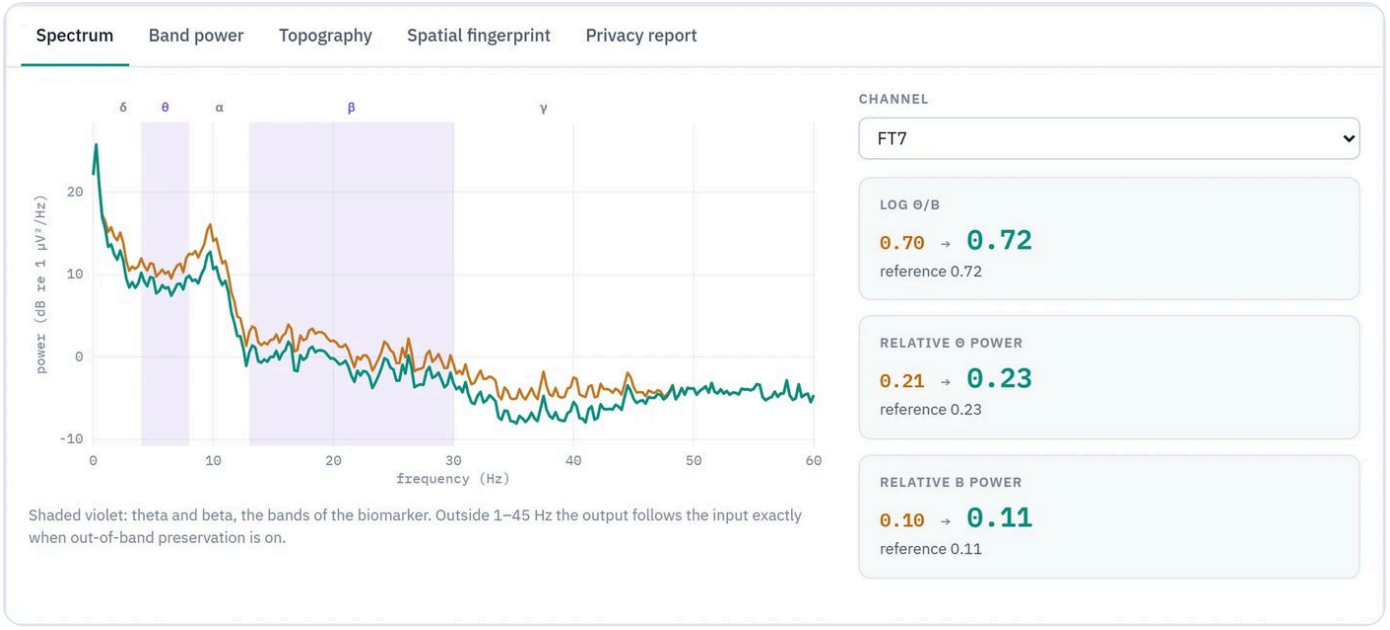


Figure 35. The Spectrum tab.

The chart shows the power spectrum in decibels, input in amber and output in teal. The theta and beta bands, which form the biomarker, are shaded violet. Outside 1–45 Hz the two curves match when **Keep content outside 1–45 Hz** was on.

The **Channel** menu shows the mean of all EEG channels (default) or any single channel. Clicking a trace in the viewer also picks it here. The three cards give, for that selection, the log theta/beta ratio, the relative theta power and the relative beta power: input, then output, with the reference value underneath.

Band power



Figure 36. The Band power tab.

The left chart shows each band's share of the total power, averaged over channels, for the input, the output and the reference. The output bars should match the reference bars. The right chart shows every EEG channel's theta/beta deviation from the reference, as a pair of bars: input in amber, output in teal. Output deviations collapse onto the zero line.

Topography

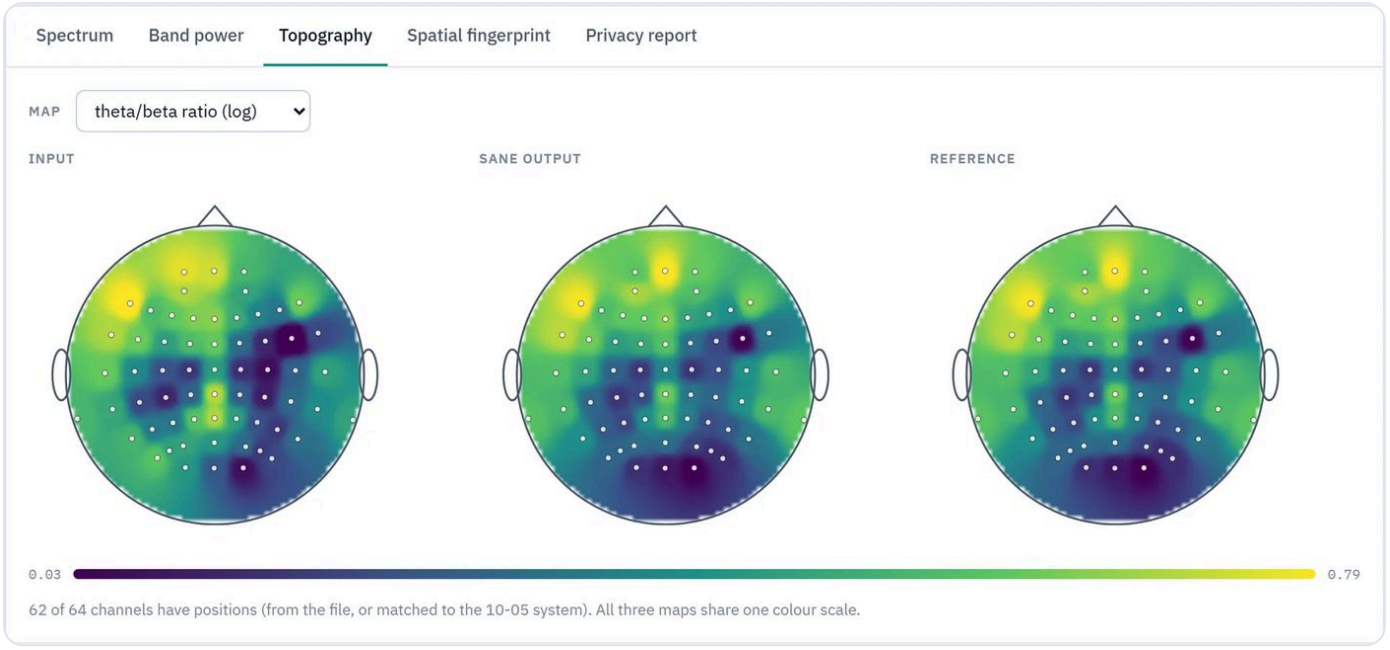


Figure 37. The Topography tab showing the theta/beta ratio across the scalp.

Three head maps, seen from above with the nose at the top, show how a measure is spread over the scalp: **Input**, **SANE output** and **Reference**. White dots are electrodes. The output map should look like the reference map.

The **Map** menu chooses the measure: theta/beta ratio (log, default), or the relative power of delta, theta, alpha, beta or gamma. All three maps share one colour scale, shown underneath with its range. The note under the scale says how many channels have a known position. Channels without one are left off the maps.



Figure 38. The same tab with the map set to relative α power.

Spatial fingerprint



Figure 39. The Spatial fingerprint tab in the alpha band.

Each square is a channel-by-channel correlation matrix: every row and column is one EEG channel, and the colour shows how strongly two channels move together in the chosen band, from −1 (blue,

opposite) through 0 (white) to +1 (red, together). The three squares are the input, the SANE output and the reference.

The **Band** buttons choose delta, theta, alpha (default), beta or gamma. The `distance` numbers above the first two squares say how far each one is from the reference: the input distance is the subject's spatial fingerprint, and the output distance shows how much of it is left. With spatial alignment off, the two distances stay similar, as intended.

Privacy report

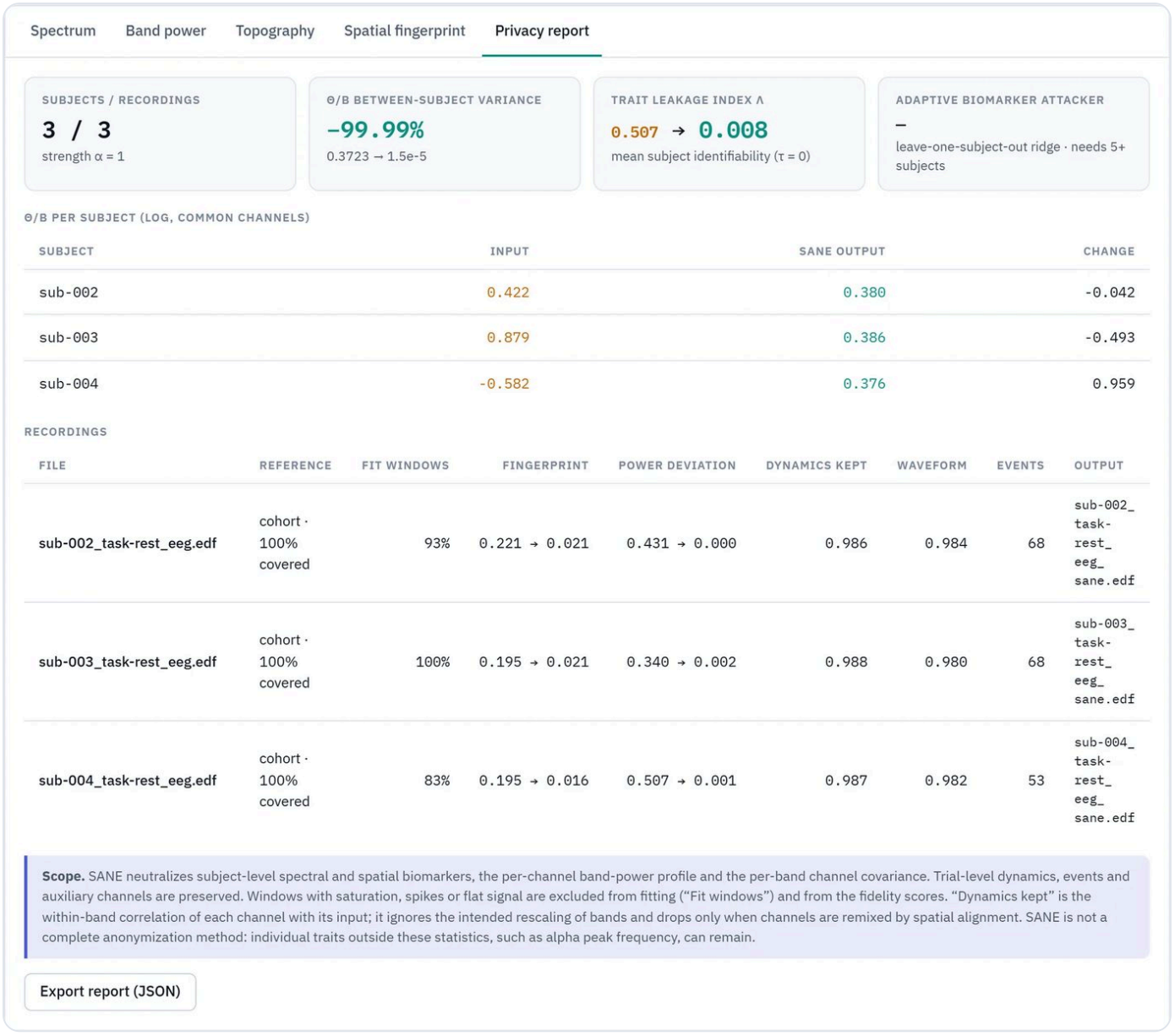


Figure 40. The Privacy report for the depression sample: between-subject theta/beta variance down 99.99 percent.

The report covers the whole session, not only the selected recording. The four cards at the top:

CARD	MEANING
Subjects / recordings	How many different subject IDs and recordings were processed, and the strength α used.
θ/β between-subject variance	How much the theta/beta biomarker still varies between subjects, before and after, and the percentage reduction. When the variance is close to zero, no threshold on this biomarker can tell patients from controls. Needs at least two subjects.
Trait Leakage Index Λ	The same index as the summary card: subject identifiability from band-power features, before and after.
Adaptive biomarker attacker	A model that tries to recover each subject's theta/beta from the output, trained on all the other subjects. ρ is the correlation between its guesses and the truth: close to 0 means the attack fails. Needs at least five subjects.

The **θ/β per subject** table lists each subject's log theta/beta ratio on the channels all subjects share: input, output and the change. In a cohort, the output values should be almost equal.

The **Recordings** table has one row per recording:

COLUMN	MEANING
Reference	The reference used. For a cohort, the percentage of this recording's channels that other subjects share.
Fit windows	The share of the recording's 4-second windows used to measure it. Windows with artifacts or missing samples are left out.
Fingerprint	Spatial fingerprint distance, input → output.
Power deviation	The typical difference between each channel's band power and the reference, on a log scale, input → output. 0 means every band of every channel sits on the reference.
Dynamics kept	Brain dynamics kept, as on the summary card. Hover over the number to see it for each band.
Waveform	Plain correlation between input and output traces on clean signal.
Events	Number of events, the same in input and output.
Output	The names of the files written for this recording.

The **Scope** box restates what SANE neutralizes and what it does not. **Export report (JSON)** downloads the full report as `SANE_REPORT.json` (section 13).

Dark theme

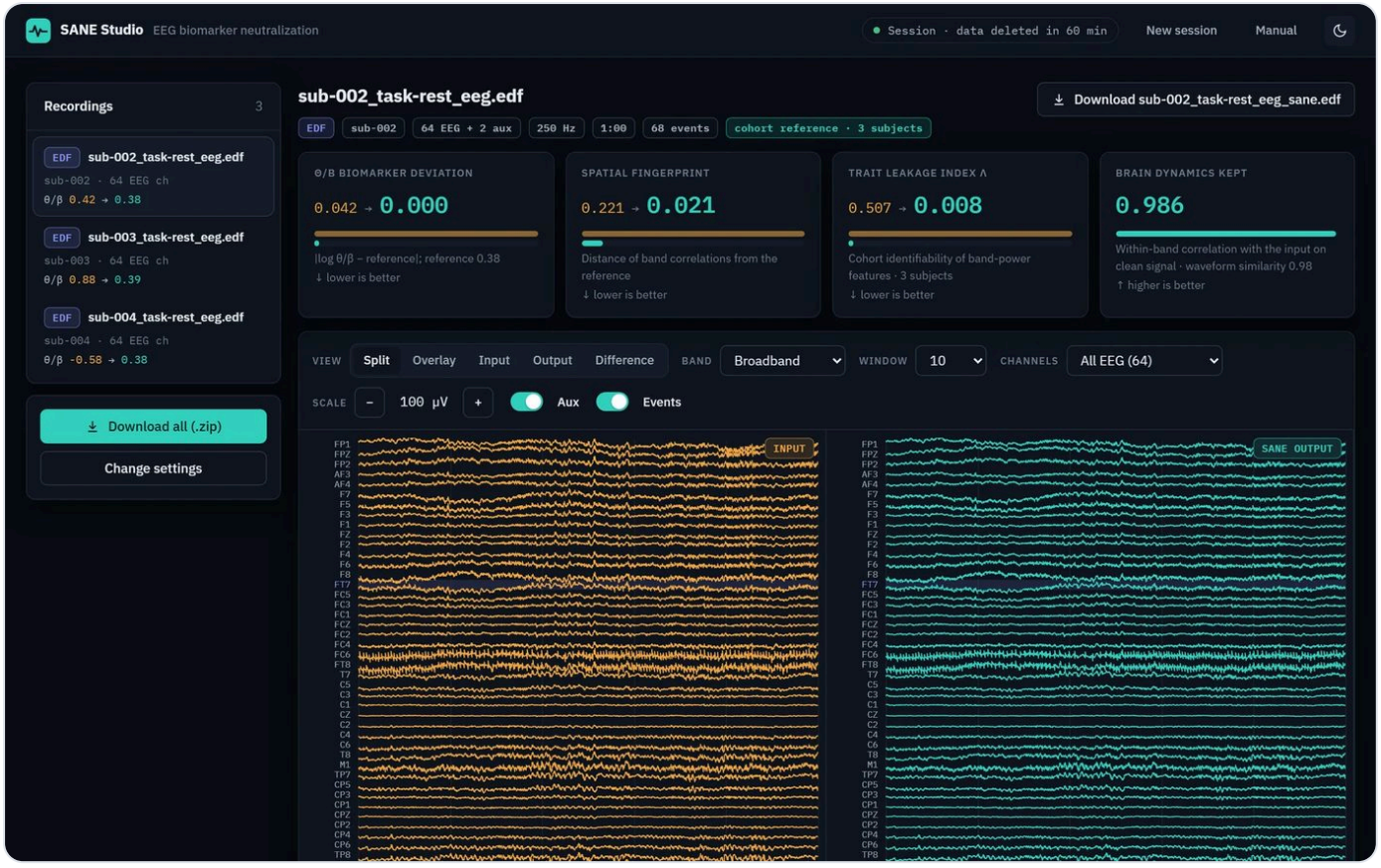


Figure 41. The Results screen in the dark theme, switched with the moon icon in the top bar.

13 Your output files

Names

Each output keeps the input name with `_sane` added: `sub-002_task-rest_eeg.edf` becomes `sub-002_task-rest_eeg_sane.edf`. FIF outputs end in `_sane_raw.fif`, following the MNE naming convention. You can therefore keep processed files next to the originals without overwriting anything.

How each format is written

FORMAT	HOW THE OUTPUT IS MADE
EDF, BDF	SANE Studio edits a copy of your uploaded file and replaces only the samples of the processed EEG channels. Labels, units, filter settings and per-channel sampling rates are kept, and every other channel stays bit-identical. Only the physical range of processed channels and, if you chose to, the personal fields change.
BrainVision	The .vhdr and .vmrk files are copied as uploaded; only the file references inside them are updated to the new names. The .eeg data keeps its number format, channel order and resolution. (If processed values no longer fit a 16-bit integer file, it is saved as 32-bit floating point instead, and the header says so.) Every marker is kept exactly.
EEGLAB	A new .set is written with the channel names, positions and events. A .set + .fdt upload comes back as .set + .fdt. A single .set comes back as a single compressed .set, about the size of the upload, unless the data exceed 2 GB, in which case it is written as .set + .fdt (a note says so).
FIF	Written with MNE. MEG and all other channels are kept. Outputs over 2 GB are split into numbered parts automatically.

What is guaranteed to be the same

- Channel names and order, sampling rate and number of samples.
- Every event or annotation, with the same time and label.
- Every non-EEG channel: EOG, ECG, EMG, triggers, sensors, MEG.
- Missing samples. Gaps stored as missing values (NaN) are still missing in the output, in the same places.

The report file

`SANE_REPORT.json` is in the **Download all** zip, and also comes from **Export report (JSON)**. It holds everything shown on the Results screen in machine-readable form: the settings used (`alpha`, `bands`), one entry per recording under `recordings` (reference, biomarkers before and after, fingerprint, power deviation, dynamics per band, fit windows, notes, output files), and the cohort measures under `cohort` (variance reduction, Trait Leakage Index, attacker results). Keep it with your processed data as a record of what was done.

14 Privacy and data handling

- **Every upload gets its own session.** Files from one session are never visible in another.
- **Sessions are deleted automatically** 60 minutes after you last used them. The top bar shows the time left.
- **New session deletes everything immediately:** uploads, working files and outputs.
- **Files are used only to produce your output.** Nothing is kept for any other purpose.
- **Personal header fields are stripped by default** (section 8).
- **When you run SANE Studio on your own computer, your data never leaves it.** Working files go to the folder set by `SANE_DATA_DIR` (section 17).

> **Limits**
>
> SANE Studio removes subject-level spectral and spatial biomarkers. It does not remove every individual trait. File names, the folder structure of a dataset, and information inside events (for example a label containing a name) are not changed. Check these yourself before sharing data.

15 Messages and what to do

While uploading

MESSAGE	MEANING AND WHAT TO DO
No supported EEG files were found in that selection.	None of the chosen files has a supported extension. Choose .edf, .bdf, .vhdr/.vmrk/.eeg, .set/.fdt or .fif files.
Upload exceeds 1024 MB.	The session would go over its size limit. Upload fewer files at a time, or ask your administrator to raise the limit.
Network error during upload	The connection to the server was lost. Check that the server is still running and try again.
Wait for processing to finish before adding files.	Files cannot be added while a session is processing. Wait for the results, click Change settings, then Add more files.
... has no matching header file and was ignored	A companion file arrived without its header, for example a .fdt without its .set, or a .eeg without its .vhdr. Upload the header too.
... is not a supported EEG file and was ignored	The file is not one of the supported formats.

Why a recording is skipped

These appear in red under the file name on the Review screen, after "Can't be processed".

REASON	WHAT TO DO
This is an EyeLink eye-tracker file (SR Research)...	The file holds eye movements, not EEG. Look for the EEG file of the same session.
No scalp EEG found; this file has ... channels	The file has no EEG channels, for example a MEG-only or empty-room .fif. It cannot be processed.
One scalp EEG channel found...	SANE needs at least two EEG channels.
Recording is shorter than 10 s.	Upload a longer recording.
This file holds epoched data; upload the continuous recording.	The file was already cut into trials. Use the continuous recording it came from.

REASON	WHAT TO DO
This is part N of a recording split across several .fif files...	Upload all parts together, including the first one.
A companion file is missing...	Upload all files of the recording together: .vhdr + .vmrk + .eeg, or .set + .fdt.
The data file ... is incomplete...	The BrainVision data file was cut off while it was copied or downloaded. Download it again.
This is a placeholder from DataLad/git-annex or Git LFS...	The real recording was never downloaded. Fetch it first, for example with `datalad get`.
... is not a valid EDF/BDF file (the header could not be parsed...)	The file is damaged or is not really in that format. Download or export it again.
Could not read ...	Another reading problem; the rest of the message gives the detail from the file reader.

During processing

MESSAGE	MEANING
No usable scalp EEG (the scalp EEG in this file contains no signal)...	All EEG channels are flat, for example because the published file has zeros in place of EEG. The channels set aside are listed with their reasons.
The EEG values are physically impossible...	The numbers in the file cannot be voltages. The file is damaged, or its header names the wrong number format.
EEG channel N contains no valid samples	One EEG channel is missing for the whole recording.
None of the recordings could be processed. ...	Every recording failed; each file's reason follows.

Notes on the Results screen

NOTE	MEANING
No other subject in this upload has channels with these names, so this recording was matched to the normative reference instead of the cohort.	This recording's montage did not overlap with the others (or only partly, with a percentage). It was still neutralized, against the normative profile.

NOTE	MEANING
The recording has N s of missing samples (NaN)...	Gaps were left out of the measurements, bridged while filtering, and are still marked missing in the output.
The data exceed the 2 GB limit of a single MATLAB file...	A large single .set was written as .set + .fdt.
Wrote a fresh ... file (...)	The original file could not be edited directly, so a new file was written instead. The data are correct, but some header details may differ from the original.

Sessions

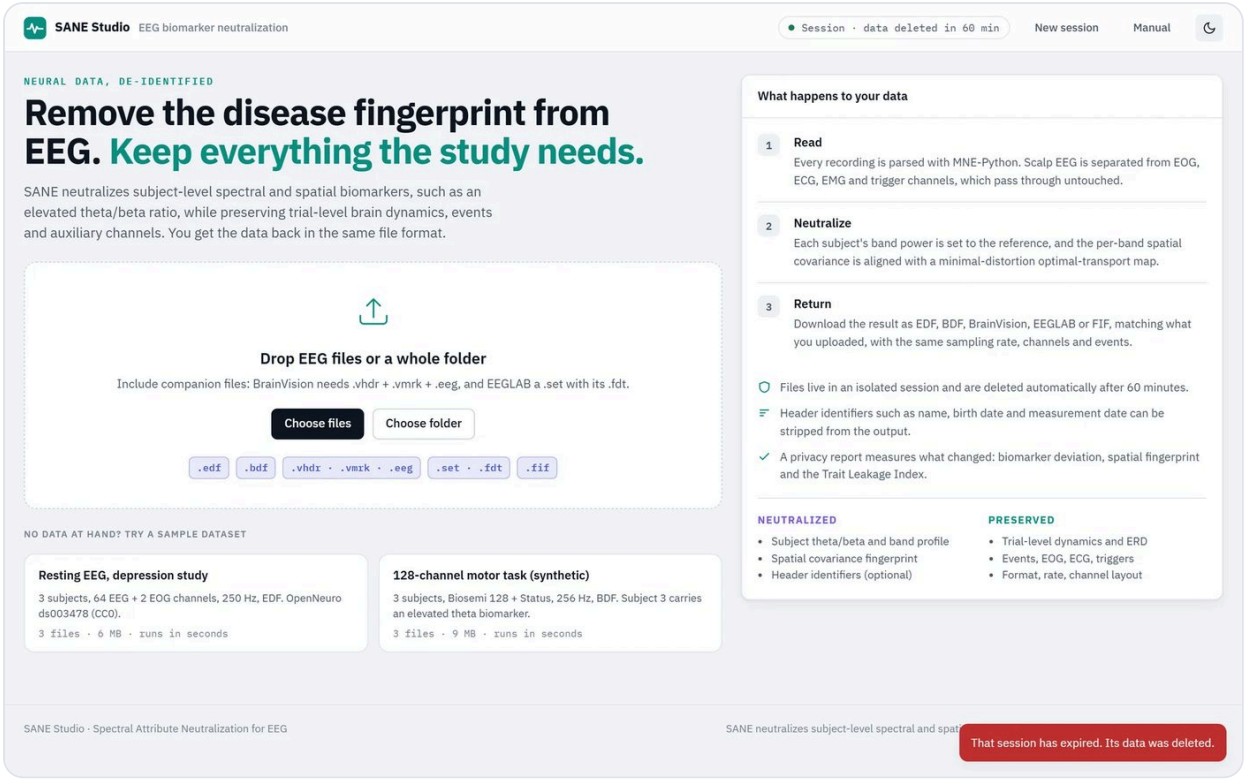


Figure 42. Opening the address of a session that no longer exists shows a message at the bottom of the screen.

MESSAGE	MEANING
That session has expired. Its data was deleted.	More than 60 minutes passed since the session was last used, or New session was clicked. Upload the files again.
This session is already processing.	The Neutralize button was pressed twice. Wait for the results.

MESSAGE	MEANING
There are no readable recordings to process.	Every recording in the session is skipped. Check the reasons on the Review screen.

16 Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	SOLUTION
"Address already in use" when starting	Another copy of SANE Studio, or another program, is using port 8000. Close the other copy, or start on a different port with `--port 8001` and open `http://localhost:8001`.
The page does not open	Check that the PowerShell window running the server is still open and shows no error, and that the address is `http://localhost:8000`.
The page looks like an older version	Press `Ctrl` + `F5` to reload without the browser cache.
Drive C: fills up	Working files go to the temp folder on C: by default. Set `$env:SANE_DATA_DIR` to another drive before starting the server (section 2), and click New session when you finish.
A very long recording is slow or fails	Processing needs memory of about twice the size of the recording's samples. Close other programs, or process long recordings one at a time.
A recording is missing from the results	It failed or was skipped. Click Change settings to see its status and reason on the Review screen.
My own theta/beta numbers differ slightly from the report	SANE measures on clean 4-second windows and leaves out artifacts. If your pipeline keeps different stretches of data, especially in long or noisy recordings, small differences are normal.
Spatial fingerprint barely changed	Spatial alignment was off, which is the automatic choice for the normative reference. Move the Spatial alignment slider up and run again if you want it removed.

Phones and tablets

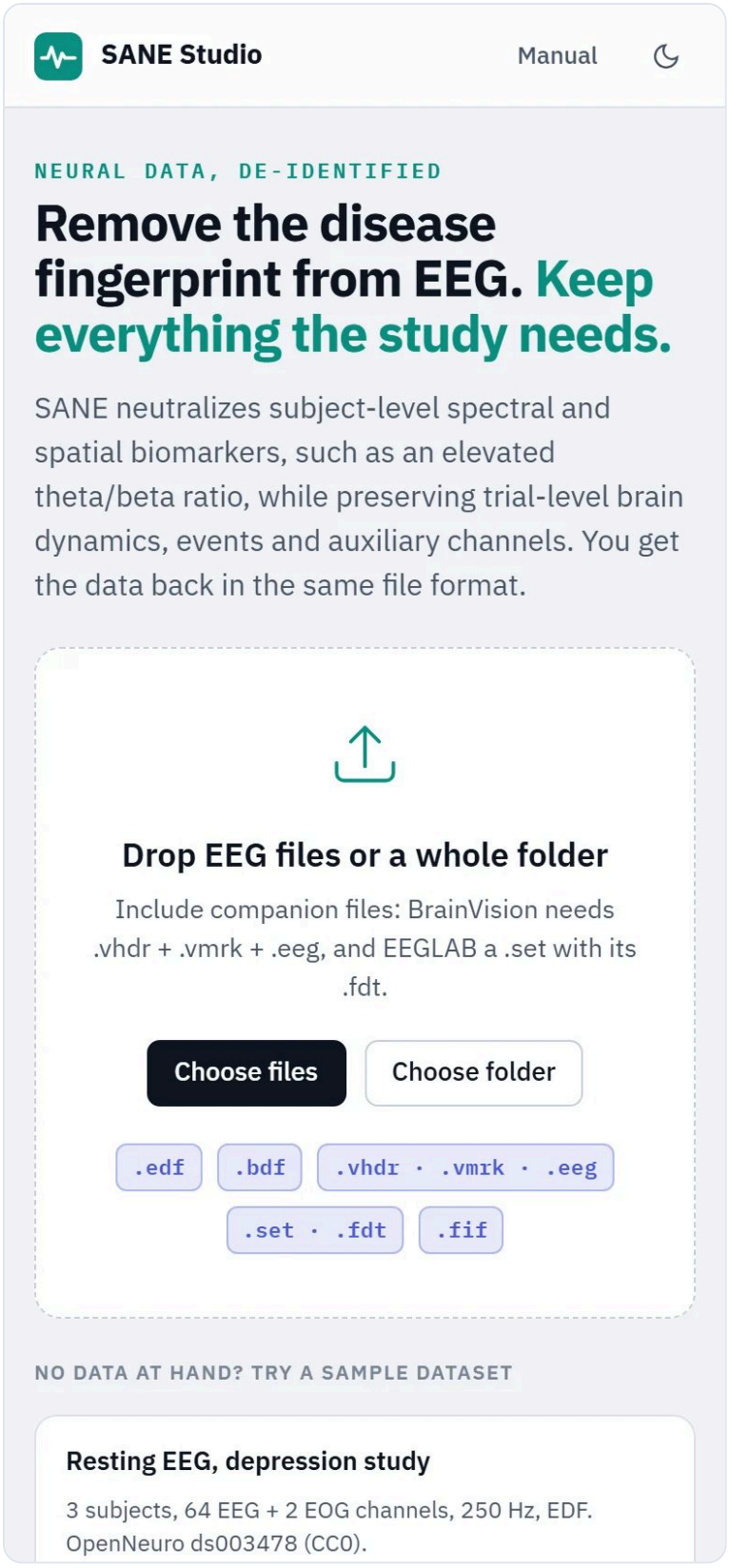


Figure 43. The Upload screen on a phone.

SANE Studio works on small screens. The layout stacks into one column, and wide tables scroll sideways inside their own box. For reviewing many channels, a laptop or desktop screen is much more comfortable.

17 For administrators

Settings

Set these environment variables before starting the server.

VARIABLE	DEFAULT	MEANING
`SANE_DATA_DIR`	system temp folder	Where sessions are stored (uploads, working files, outputs).
`SANE_TTL_MINUTES`	60	Minutes of inactivity after which a session is deleted.
`SANE_MAX_UPLOAD_MB`	1024	Upload limit per session, in MB.
`SANE_WORKERS`	2	How many sessions can process at the same time. Others wait their turn.
`PORT`	7860	Port used inside the Docker container.

Hosting

The server version includes a `Dockerfile`, so it runs on any container host. Its `deploy` folder runs it on one Oracle Cloud Always Free server behind Caddy, with free HTTPS; `deploy/README.md` has every step. The browser version is a static website for GitHub Pages; `DEPLOY.md` in its folder has every step.

API

Everything the web page does goes through a documented HTTP API. Interactive documentation is at `/api/docs`.

ENDPOINT	PURPOSE
`GET /api/health`	Server status and upload limit.
`GET /api/samples`	List the sample datasets.
`POST /api/samples/{id}`	Start a session from a sample dataset.
`POST /api/jobs`	Upload files (multipart field `files`) and create a session.
`POST /api/jobs/{id}/files`	Add files to a session.

ENDPOINT	PURPOSE
GET /api/jobs/{id}	Session state, recordings, progress and report.
POST /api/jobs/{id}/run	Start processing. JSON body: `alpha`, `spatial_alpha` (null for auto), `reference`, `spatial_model`, `preserve_oob`, `anonymize`, `subjects`.
GET /api/jobs/{id}/download	All outputs and the report as a zip.
GET /api/jobs/{id}/download/{rid}	One recording's output.
DELETE /api/jobs/{id}	Delete a session now.
GET /api/jobs/{id}/rec/{rid}/…	Data for the viewer and charts: `meta`, `window`, `analysis`, `spatial`.

Tests

Run these from the project folder. The last two need the server running.

```
python tests/test_formats.py
python tests/test_customer_uploads.py
python tests/test_downloaded.py D:/sane_testdata http://localhost:8000
```

To regenerate the screenshots in this manual, run `python tools/manual_screenshots.py http://localhost:8000`.

18 Glossary

Band	A frequency range of the EEG: delta (δ) 1–4 Hz, theta (θ) 4–8 Hz, alpha (α) 8–13 Hz, beta (β) 13–30 Hz, gamma (γ) 30–45 Hz.
Band power	How much signal a channel has in a band, averaged over the recording.
Biomarker	A measurable property of the signal that is linked to a condition. The theta/beta ratio, for example, is often raised in ADHD and some other conditions.
Brain dynamics kept	How closely the output follows the input from moment to moment within each band. 1 means unchanged apart from intended scaling.
Cohort	The group of subjects uploaded together. Its average is the cohort reference.
Companion file	A file that belongs to a recording's header file: the .vmrk and .eeg of a BrainVision .vhdr, or the .fdt of an EEGLAB .set.
Continuous recording	A recording kept as one uninterrupted stretch of data, as opposed to an epoched file cut into trials.
Fit windows	The clean 4-second stretches of a recording used to measure it.
Normative profile	The built-in typical spectral shape used as the reference when there is no cohort.
Pass-through channel	A channel SANE does not change, such as EOG, ECG or a trigger. Also called an auxiliary channel.
Reference	The profile every subject is moved toward: the cohort average or the normative profile.
Session	One upload and everything made from it. It is deleted after 60 minutes without use.
Spatial fingerprint	The pattern of how a person's EEG channels move together. It can identify a person and can carry disease information.
Strength α	How far each subject's spectral profile moves toward the reference, from 0 (not at all) to 1 (all the way).
Spatial alignment	How far each subject's spatial fingerprint moves toward the reference, from 0 to 1.
Theta/beta ratio	Theta power divided by beta power, shown on a log scale. 0 means equal power in both bands.
Trait Leakage Index Λ	How well subjects can be told apart from their band-power features, from 0 (not at all) to 1 (fully).